Synthesizing the Consensus: Generative AI and the Pricing of Multi-Provider Earnings Forecasts*

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Abstract

This paper studies the effect of generative AI (GenAI) on capital markets' use of consensus earnings forecasts from different forecast data providers (FDPs) that construct economically distinct numbers for the same firm-quarter. I find that GenAI facilitates the market's selective reliance on individual FDPs and supports an accuracy-weighted synthesis of their forecasts. In S&P 1500 firm-quarters over 2021–2025 covered by all five FDPs, post-ChatGPT announcement reactions align more closely with provider accuracy ranks and consensus predictive value. After ChatGPT, returns per percentage point of surprise rise 2.40 percentage points more under the accuracy-weighted than the equal-weighted consensus and 2.67 more than I/B/E/S. Across the GPT-capability regimes, this accuracy premium is undetectable before browsing, positive under browsing, and significant against both only under native search. Further analysis shows that the premium concentrates where nonrecurring items are large and, against I/B/E/S, where providers disagree and, once browsing arrives, in high-LLM-visibility firms, whose forecasts GenAI retrieves. The evidence indicates that GenAI facilitates selective cross-FDP integration of consensus forecasts.

Keywords: Generative AI, Analyst, Forecast Data Provider, Consensus Forecast, Information Processing, Earnings Response Coefficient.

JEL classification: G11, G14, G41, M41.

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1 Introduction

Sell-side analyst consensus forecasts are the market's primary benchmark for evaluating realized earnings (e.g., Bradshaw et al., 2017; Kothari, 2001). The earnings surprise relative to this benchmark helps explain announcement-window stock price reactions and post-announcement drift (e.g., Bartov et al., 2002; Bernard and Thomas, 1989; Livnat and Mendenhall, 2006). Earnings surprises also affect price discovery, trading volume, and firms' disclosure choices. Yet the consensus is not a single number. Five *forecast data providers* (FDPs), I/B/E/S, FactSet, Bloomberg, S&P Capital IQ, and Zacks, construct economically distinct consensus forecasts for the same firm-quarter (Larocque et al., 2026). Their proprietary aggregation methods differ in screening rules, treatment of unusual items, and analyst-coverage thresholds (Bochkay et al., 2022). The resulting earnings surprises differ beyond rounding in 58 percent of firm-quarters.[1]

This paper examines whether generative AI (GenAI) changes the market's reliance on individual providers and the combination of their forecasts reflected in prices. Following ChatGPT's release in late 2022, industry surveys document widespread investor adoption (CFA Institute, 2024). Recent research connects GenAI use to financial analysis and capital-market outcomes (e.g., Bertomeu et al., 2025; Blankespoor et al., 2026; Chang et al., 2026; Cheng et al., 2025; Liu and Subasi, 2026; Xue et al., 2025). A retrieval-enabled GenAI query can bring forecasts and earnings histories from multiple websites into one response and support their combination according to accuracy. This capability may reduce the effort required to compare competing earnings benchmarks.

Using S&P 1500 firm-quarters from 2021 to 2025, I find greater reliance on accurate providers after ChatGPT's release. Announcement returns become more closely aligned with a surprise that weights providers by recent accuracy, relative to the I/B/E/S and equal-weighted surprises. In horse-race regressions, the loading on the accuracy-weighted surprise rises 2.40 percentage points more than the loading on the equal-weighted surprise and 2.67 percentage points more than the loading on the I/B/E/S surprise. Each increase amounts to 80 to 90 percent of the pre-ChatGPT

[1] In a sample of 94,030 firm-quarters covered by all five FDPs over 2002–2020, Larocque et al. (2026) find that at least one FDP signals a miss while another signals a beat in 9 percent of firm-quarters.

return loading on the I/B/E/S surprise estimated on its own. The timing and cross-sectional patterns support a role for retrieval in this synthesis.

The potential benefit of synthesis arises because the most accurate provider varies across firms and over time (Larocque et al., 2026). A provider's relative accuracy persists across quarters, making recent performance informative for assigning weights. Prior evidence shows that market reactions align more closely with higher-quality providers when providers disagree about whether earnings miss or beat expectations (Larocque et al., 2026). This evidence leaves open whether lower processing costs strengthen the market's use of accuracy information when combining forecasts. In my sample, the pre-ChatGPT difference between return loadings on accuracy-weighted and equal-weighted surprises is statistically indistinguishable from zero.

I argue that processing costs limit investors' use of provider accuracy in forming earnings expectations. Free websites report consensus forecasts and actual earnings histories for the providers they carry. Investors must recognize that the forecasts differ, retrieve the relevant histories, and assess each provider's accuracy for the firm. They must then translate that assessment into weights and repeat the process for each firm-quarter they follow. These tasks span the awareness, acquisition, and integration costs in the disclosure-processing-cost framework of Blankespoor et al. (2020). By lowering these costs, GenAI may increase reliance on accurate providers and shift the market's earnings benchmark toward accuracy-weighted synthesis. The framework also predicts a larger shift when synthesis is more accessible or offers greater benefits.

These predictions are not obvious *ex ante*. Combining heterogeneous, partially independent forecasts can improve accuracy relative to relying on a single provider (e.g., Ahlers and Lakonishok, 1983; Bates and Granger, 1969). Yet estimation error can offset the gains from unequal weighting (Clemen, 1989; Timmermann, 2006). Michaely et al. (2024) find limited economic benefits from replacing the broader consensus with the average forecast of high-quality analysts within a provider. Limited-attention research also shows that competing information can weaken investors' responses to relevant news (Hirshleifer et al., 2009). Easier access may therefore increase the information investors must assess without improving their expectations. Large language models (LLMs) can

also rely on memorization instead of reasoning (e.g., Lopez-Lira et al., 2025). Whether GenAI strengthens the market's use of relative accuracy remains an empirical question.

The empirical analysis first examines reliance on individual FDPs. The sample includes firm-quarters with consensus earnings-per-share (EPS) forecasts from all five providers.[2] I rank the five providers by trailing accuracy within each firm-quarter. I then estimate how the earnings response coefficient (ERC; e.g., Collins and Kothari, 1989; Easton and Zmijewski, 1989) on each provider's surprise varies with that rank. The ERC increment associated with a one-rank improvement in accuracy roughly doubles after ChatGPT, from 0.306 to 0.621. The response to each provider's own surprise also rises, significantly so for four of the five providers. Greater selectivity thus takes the form of a relative reweighting toward more accurate providers within a broader increase in responsiveness to earnings surprises.

Complementary evidence comes from changes in I/B/E/S's accuracy rank. After ChatGPT, analysts herd toward the prevailing I/B/E/S consensus significantly less in firms in which I/B/E/S loses rank around the release than in firms in which its rank remains unchanged. The difference is 4.8 percentage points relative to a 32-percent base rate. There is no significant offsetting change in herding where I/B/E/S gains rank. Relative to firms in which I/B/E/S's rank remains unchanged, the market's response to its surprise weakens significantly where its rank declines. The corresponding change is not statistically significant where its rank improves. This asymmetry is consistent with pre-ChatGPT overreliance on I/B/E/S.[3]

A stronger response to accurate providers does not establish how the market combines their forecasts. I therefore construct an accuracy-weighted standardized unexpected earnings (SUE) measure using each FDP's trailing forecast accuracy for the firm. Weights based on forecast errors observed before the announcement apply to each provider's own surprise.[4] I compare this measure

[2]The sample begins in 2021 to provide about two years of announcements before ChatGPT's November 30, 2022 release and three years after it. Bloomberg's consensus history is accessible only for five years.

[3]The ERC gradient with respect to predictive value, measured by how closely the I/B/E/S consensus anticipates the firm's street earnings a year ahead, also more than doubles after ChatGPT. This increase alone does not distinguish a GenAI explanation from alternatives.

[4]Each provider's surprise pairs its consensus with its own reported actual earnings. The market's weights need not equal mine.

with the I/B/E/S surprise and the equal-weighted surprise. The I/B/E/S surprise captures reliance on a single provider. The equal-weighted surprise captures combination without differentiating providers by accuracy. Each horse-race regression includes the accuracy-weighted surprise and one benchmark surprise. I term the difference between their loadings the *accuracy premium*. After ChatGPT, the loading on the accuracy-weighted surprise rises sharply, while the loading on the benchmark surprise stays flat or declines. The premium widens significantly against both benchmarks.[5]

The timing of the premium indicates a role for retrieval. I distinguish four GPT-capability regimes based on major changes in publicly available capabilities: pre-ChatGPT, text-only, browsing, and native search. Against I/B/E/S, the estimated premium rises from negative in the pre-ChatGPT and text-only regimes to 1.52 percentage points under browsing and a significant 4.91 percentage points under native search. Against equal weighting, it rises from statistically indistinguishable from zero to a significant 2.43 and 2.55 percentage points, respectively. The largest point estimates occur under native search. These patterns are consistent with retrieval facilitating integration across providers, although timing alone does not separate retrieval from concurrent developments.[6]

I next examine whether the premium is larger for firms whose forecasts receive more source citations in browsing responses. As a retrospective proxy for retrieval accessibility, I construct *LLM visibility* using queries issued in 2026, after the sample period, to a browsing-enabled model, ChatGPT with GPT-4o. The measure counts source citations, including repeats, returned in response to requests for a firm's consensus forecast.[7] It is empirically distinct from conventional proxies for firm prominence. The premium is larger in high-visibility firms in the browsing and native-search regimes. The high-minus-low visibility gap is insignificant at the five-percent level in the pre-ChatGPT and text-only regimes. It reaches 2.7 to 3.0 percentage points under browsing ($p < 0.05$) and 3.1 to 4.2 percentage points under native search. The association between visibility

[5]Following the earnings-surprise trading-strategy literature (e.g., Battalio and Mendenhall, 2005; Michaely et al., 2024), a quintile long–short portfolio sorted on the price-scaled difference between the accuracy-weighted consensus and each benchmark consensus earns 0.63–1.35 percent per announcement. These announcement-window returns do not by themselves establish the strategy's tradability.

[6]A regression that includes both boundaries does not separately identify the changes at ChatGPT's release and the browsing-regime boundary. The timing tests also cannot distinguish three concurrent developments: the SEC's December 2022 update to its guidance on non-GAAP measures, rising analyst coverage, and providers' own AI tools.

[7]LLM visibility is the average citation count across three queries for the firm's next-quarter consensus EPS.

and the premium in these regimes supports the synthesis interpretation.

The framework also predicts a larger premium when accuracy weighting offers greater benefits. Against I/B/E/S, the premium concentrates in firm-quarters with high cross-FDP disagreement, where distinguishing among providers may offer greater benefits. Against equal weighting, the change in the premium is similar across the two halves of this partition. Against both benchmarks, the premium concentrates in firm-quarters with large special items, where differences in providers' treatment of nonrecurring items are more consequential. Together, the regime estimates and cross-sectional results support a shift toward accuracy-weighted synthesis that varies with retrieval accessibility and the benefits of distinguishing among providers.[8]

This paper makes three contributions. First, I contribute to the literature on FDPs and consensus construction (Bochkay et al., 2022; Larocque et al., 2026) by documenting changes in the earnings benchmark reflected in prices. The findings show that the market's relative reliance on providers varies with the information environment. For researchers and practitioners, a widely used provider's consensus may therefore represent market expectations differently as information technology changes.

Second, I contribute evidence on synthesis to the literature on the capital-market consequences of GenAI (e.g., Bertomeu et al., 2025; Blankespoor et al., 2026; Chang et al., 2026; Cheng et al., 2025; Liu and Subasi, 2026; Lopez-Lira and Tang, 2026; Xue et al., 2025). The findings identify accuracy-weighted synthesis as a channel through which GenAI can influence earnings-announcement prices. The LLM visibility measure records source citations in GenAI responses about individual firms and can be adapted as models evolve.

Third, I apply the disclosure-processing-cost framework of Blankespoor et al. (2020) to investors' use of accuracy information across competing sources. Earlier studies examine EDGAR, XBRL, social media, and robo-journalism (Blankespoor, 2019; Blankespoor et al., 2018, 2014; Drake et al., 2015; Loughran and McDonald, 2017). The accuracy premium rises in regimes with

[8]Further tests do not identify which investors perform the synthesis. The premium does not concentrate detectably in firms with high retail or institutional ownership. No investor group's order flow, trading volume, or fund holdings shift toward the accuracy-weighted surprise against both benchmarks at the five-percent level. Against the equal-weighted benchmark, the premium rises more in firms with lower analyst coverage.

retrieval and is larger in firms with greater LLM visibility and in firm-quarters with large special items. These patterns support a processing-cost explanation in which the market's use of source quality depends on access to information and the benefit of distinguishing among sources.

The paper proceeds as follows. Section 2 reviews the literature and develops the framework and its two predictions. Section 3 describes the data, GPT-capability regimes, and accuracy-weighted surprise. Section 4 tests selective reliance on individual FDPs. Section 5 validates the accuracy-weighted construction and estimates the accuracy premium across regimes. Section 6 examines its variation with the benefits of synthesis and LLM visibility. Section 7 addresses six remaining concerns, including the premium's timing within the post-period and the identity of investors who synthesize. Section 8 concludes.

2 Related Literature and Theoretical Framework

2.1 Related Literature

2.1.1 Consensus Forecasts and Forecast Data Providers

Research on analyst forecasts links the quality of earnings expectations to investors' interpretation of earnings news. Consensus forecasts provide a benchmark for evaluating realized earnings in both research and practice (Bartov et al., 2002; Beyer et al., 2010; Bradshaw et al., 2017; Kothari, 2001). At the individual-analyst level, prices respond more strongly to revisions from more accurate or higher-status analysts (Clement and Tse, 2003; Park and Stice, 2000; Stickel, 1992). This evidence motivates examining whether the market also distinguishes among the providers that aggregate analysts' forecasts.

The quality of a consensus depends partly on how its provider constructs it. Forecast data providers (FDPs) screen analysts' submissions and determine which earnings components enter their reported forecasts and actuals. Bochkay et al. (2022) show that changes in I/B/E/S's treatment of unexpected charges and gains alter the predictive properties of street earnings and price discovery

around announcements.[9] Their evidence establishes that providers' construction choices have consequences for the information investors receive. It also motivates separating changes in the forecasts providers supply from changes in how investors use competing forecasts.

Cross-provider evidence links these differences to market responses. Larocque et al. (2026) document economically meaningful differences among five FDPs' consensus forecasts and earnings surprises for the same firm-quarter. When providers disagree about whether a firm misses or beats expectations, market reactions are more likely to align with higher-quality providers. Their composite quality measure includes historical forecast accuracy and the predictive value of street earnings, among other attributes. On average, I/B/E/S and Capital IQ exhibit stronger alignment than the other providers. This evidence leaves open whether lower processing costs shift market expectations toward a combination that uses accuracy information across providers.

Evidence on analyst quality cautions against assuming that identifying more accurate forecasts necessarily benefits investors. Michaely et al. (2024) find limited economic benefits from using the average forecast of high-quality analysts in place of the broader consensus, although dispersion among those analysts' forecasts contains economically useful information. They discuss error cancellation, imperfect persistence in analyst quality, and the costs of identifying high-quality analysts as reasons why quality-based selection need not improve investment outcomes. Their analysis concerns aggregation across analysts within a provider. Combining FDP consensus forecasts introduces differences in providers' screening and earnings-adjustment rules, in addition to differences in their underlying analyst forecasts. The within-provider evidence thus motivates testing the benefits of cross-provider synthesis, without presuming that recent accuracy yields useful combination weights.

2.1.2 Disclosure Processing Costs and Limited Attention

The disclosure-processing-cost literature explains why investors may rely on a familiar consensus even when alternatives are publicly available. Blankespoor et al. (2020) distinguish the

[9] *Street* earnings reflect adjustments to GAAP earnings for items such as restructuring charges, impairments, and gains on asset sales. Pairing each forecast with its provider's reported actual avoids mixing sources, but does not guarantee a common accounting basis. In particular, Bloomberg's reported actual closely follows GAAP basic EPS despite its street consensus. Section 3.1 discusses this distinction.

costs of becoming aware of information, acquiring it, and integrating it into decisions. Research on Twitter and EDGAR examines how dissemination and access affect investors' use of disclosures (Blankespoor et al., 2014; Drake et al., 2015; Loughran and McDonald, 2017). Studies of XBRL and robo-journalism examine the effects of making disclosed information easier to process (Blankespoor, 2019; Blankespoor et al., 2018). Open conference calls and the business press also broaden access to firm information (Bushee et al., 2003, 2010; Kimbrough, 2005). Limited-attention research shows why access alone need not ensure that investors incorporate available information into prices (Cohen and Lou, 2012; DellaVigna and Pollet, 2009; deHaan et al., 2015; Hirshleifer et al., 2009). The same research implies that adding sources can lower the quality of the earnings expectation when investors cannot assess each source's reliability cheaply (Hirshleifer et al., 2009; Blankespoor et al., 2020). With five providers of unequal accuracy, the value of the additional sources depends on the investor's ability to assess them.

The FDP setting applies this framework to the choice among competing earnings benchmarks. Investors face several forecasts of the same firm's earnings, each constructed under different rules and accompanied by a different accuracy record. Making these forecasts available leaves investors with the task of assessing their relative reliability. Because that reliability can vary across firms and over time, a provider's overall reputation may be an imperfect guide to the forecast most relevant for a particular announcement. The relevant processing task is to assess how much each forecast should contribute to the earnings expectation against which the announcement is evaluated.

2.1.3 Artificial Intelligence in Capital Markets

Earlier applications of AI in finance often use models developed for a particular prediction or classification task. These methods extract information from both structured data and unstructured inputs, including text (Goldstein et al., 2021). For example, Gu et al. (2020) show that machine learning improves return prediction by capturing nonlinear interactions among predictors. Adapting such methods to a new investment problem can require preparing inputs, estimating and validating a model, and maintaining the resulting analytical process. These requirements create costs that can limit investors' ability to apply the technology.

Generative AI offers a more flexible way to obtain analytical assistance. A pretrained large language model (LLM) can perform different tasks specified through natural-language instructions and examples, without being retrained for each task (Brown et al., 2020). Investors can use the same model to request an interpretation, compare alternatives, and refine an analysis through follow-up questions. This flexibility may reduce the expertise and effort required to adapt an analytical tool to a particular investment question. ChatGPT-derived assessments of news headlines also predict stock returns (Lopez-Lira and Tang, 2026).

Retrieval adds a separate capability that is particularly relevant to consensus forecasts. When connected to browsing tools, an LLM can obtain current external information to supplement its training data and the material supplied by users (OpenAI, 2023). In the FDP setting, this capability can connect a request to compare providers with the acquisition of their forecasts and earnings histories. Conventional software can also retrieve forecasts and calculate combination weights. The proposed benefit of retrieval-enabled GenAI is to make these steps accessible through a common natural-language interface, potentially lowering the cost of comparing sources repeatedly across firms and quarters.

AI also changes the production of financial information. Analysts at brokerages with greater AI adoption issue more accurate forecasts (Kimbrough et al., 2026). GenAI narrows the forecast-accuracy gap between nonprofessional and professional contributors (Liu and Subasi, 2026). On Seeking Alpha, AI adoption increases authors' output and coverage, although AI-generated articles elicit weaker market responses than human-written articles (Bradshaw et al., 2026). These findings show that AI can change both the supply and the quality of information available to investors.

Studies of investor use connect these analytical capabilities to financial decisions. Brokerage queries and survey responses show that investors use GenAI to interpret and contextualize financial information (Blankespoor et al., 2026). Trading declines during ChatGPT outages (Cheng et al., 2025), and bid–ask spreads widen during Italy's ChatGPT ban (Bertomeu et al., 2025). Retail trading also becomes more closely aligned with AI-derived earnings-call sentiment after ChatGPT's

release (Chang et al., 2026). I examine whether GenAI's diffusion coincides with greater alignment of announcement returns with providers' relative accuracy and with an accuracy-weighted synthesis of their forecasts.

2.2 Theoretical Framework and Predictions

Figure 1 summarizes a framework that weighs the benefits of synthesis against its processing costs. I define *synthesis* as retrieving forecasts and their histories, assessing source quality, and combining the forecasts using that assessment. Combining forecasts can reduce error by diversifying provider-specific noise (Bates and Granger, 1969; Clemen, 1989; Granger and Ramanathan, 1984; Stock and Watson, 2004; Timmermann, 2006). The two benchmarks in this paper pool different inputs: I/B/E/S combines individual analysts' forecasts, whereas the equal-weighted benchmark combines FDP consensus forecasts. Neither adjusts weights across FDPs to reflect their recent accuracy for a particular firm.

Predictable differences in provider accuracy create scope for improving on these benchmarks. FDP accuracy varies across firms and over time (Larocque et al., 2026), and providers' methodologies affect the information content of their reported earnings (Bochkay et al., 2022). Assigning greater weight to more accurate providers can improve on equal weighting (Bates and Granger, 1969). The gain depends on whether recent accuracy predicts subsequent accuracy. Noisy or unstable estimates can offset the benefit of assigning unequal weights.

Processing costs can prevent investors from realizing this benefit. Investors must first recognize that FDP forecasts and their relative accuracy differ. They must then retrieve each provider's current forecast and historical consensus–actual pairs, assess its accuracy for the firm, and use that assessment to assign weights. These tasks span the awareness, acquisition, and integration costs in Blankespoor et al. (2020). Repeating them across firm-quarters requires time; automating them at scale requires programming and data-engineering expertise. An investor may therefore prefer a familiar provider or an equal-weighted combination when the expected gain from accuracy weighting is smaller than its cost. The historical alignment of announcement returns with the I/B/E/S surprise in Larocque et al. (2026) is consistent with this explanation.

Retrieval-enabled GenAI can lower both the recurring time cost and the expertise required for synthesis. An investor can ask an LLM to retrieve forecasts and earnings histories from public websites, assess accuracy, and compute a weighted consensus.[10] The task requires consensus and actual earnings histories, without reverse-engineering providers' proprietary methodologies. Both an analyst with terminal access and an individual investor can issue such a query. The framework therefore requires synthesis by investors whose expectations enter prices, without specifying an investor group (Section 7.6).

The accuracy-weighted composite proxies for the synthesis that this process supports. The browsing model retrieves forecasts from free websites, without access to FDP subscription products. Among the five providers, those websites name only Zacks and S&P Global as their current sources.[11] The correspondence between the composite and the forecasts retrieved by the model is therefore an assumption, not an observed match. The tests provide their most direct evidence on retrieval through the GPT-capability regimes and LLM visibility (Sections 5 and 6). I test the role of accuracy in integration indirectly through the rank-selectivity tests in Section 4.1 and the special-items and dispersion partitions in Section 6.1.

The framework predicts greater use of provider quality as the cost of synthesis falls. I measure quality primarily by trailing forecast accuracy for the firm (Section 3.5) and also examine predictive value for future performance (Section 4.3). The shift should be larger when forecasts are easier to retrieve and when distinguishing among providers offers greater benefits. Disagreement creates scope for such benefits when it reflects differences in forecast accuracy. Providers' differing treatment of special items is one source of this disagreement. The framework holds providers' construction rules and the resulting street earnings fixed.[12] Changes in awareness, acquisition,

[10] Online Appendix A.2 presents a pilot that asks a browsing model to complete these steps. Table OA1 reports the October 2026 pilot results. The model retrieves per-site histories whose reported EPS figures match one of the five providers' actuals within two cents at a mean rate of 98 percent per response. It computes site-level accuracy and an accuracy-weighted consensus in 28 to 62 percent of responses, depending on the prompt. Online Appendix A.1 describes the query used to measure LLM visibility.

[11] Table OA2 lists the provider that each cited site names as the source of its estimates.

[12] Section 7.2 examines this assumption at ChatGPT's release and the browsing boundary. A supply-side change, such as the 2009 I/B/E/S methodology change studied by Bochkay et al. (2022), provides a separate explanation for changes in the market's use of forecasts.

and integration costs yield two predictions.

Prediction 1. After ChatGPT's release, the market places greater relative weight on FDP forecasts with higher recent accuracy or greater predictive value for future performance. The alignment of announcement returns with an accuracy-weighted synthesis strengthens relative to their alignment with a single-FDP consensus or an equal-weighted combination.

Prediction 2. The post-ChatGPT shift is stronger for firms whose forecasts LLMs can more readily retrieve, in firm-quarters with greater cross-FDP disagreement, and in firm-quarters with larger special items.

3 Data, Sample, and the Accuracy-Weighted Surprise

3.1 Heterogeneity in the FDPs' Consensus Forecasts

Differences in analyst coverage and earnings definitions give rise to distinct consensus forecasts across FDPs. I/B/E/S, FactSet, Bloomberg, S&P Capital IQ, and Zacks each construct and sell analyst-consensus EPS information. Each provider includes a different subset of analysts and applies its own recency cutoffs and outlier screens. Providers also differ in their treatment of charges, gains, and other adjustments to reported earnings (Bochkay et al., 2022). These choices affect both their consensus forecasts and their reported actuals.

Pairs that include Bloomberg disagree in 88.5 to 90.8 percent of firm-quarters, compared with 16.3 to 38.3 percent for the other pairs.[13] The Bloomberg actual in these data closely follows GAAP basic EPS, whereas its consensus forecasts street earnings. Its surprise therefore includes an accounting-basis difference as well as forecast error. Bloomberg has the largest trailing absolute error in most firm-quarters, so it generally receives the smallest accuracy weight. A street-basis Bloomberg actual is unavailable in these data. The main composite retains Bloomberg, and Section 7.5 repeats the headline tests without it.

The providers also differ in accuracy, and no single provider consistently supplies the most accurate forecast. I/B/E/S ranks highest on average across composite measures of FDP quality (Larocque et al., 2026). Yet it is the most accurate provider in only 16.9 percent of firm-quarters in my S&P 1500 sample (untabulated), below the 20 percent implied by a uniform draw across

[13] Table OA3 reports the share of firm-quarters in which reported actuals differ for each of the ten provider pairs.

five providers. These differences create scope for weighting providers according to their recent accuracy for each firm.[14]

3.2 Data and Sample

I collect quarterly consensus EPS forecasts and reported actuals separately from all five FDPs. I obtain I/B/E/S and Zacks data through WRDS, using the I/B/E/S Summary History file and the Zacks Estimates database, respectively. I download FactSet, Bloomberg, and S&P Capital IQ histories firm by firm through proprietary terminals or institutional portals.[15]

Table 1 summarizes the sample selection. The initial sample contains 29,395 firm-quarters across 1,502 S&P 1500 firms with earnings announcements during 2021–2025.[16] I apply the S&P 1500 constituent list at the data-collection date to every quarter in the sample; membership is therefore not point in time. I use I/B/E/S announcement dates to center all event windows. Requiring a consensus from every provider in the announcement quarter leaves 25,027 firm-quarters. I then exclude observations with missing market outcomes, controls, constructed returns, or predicted surprises, and remove singleton firms. The final sample contains 23,833 firm-quarters across 1,334 firms.

The accuracy weights use forecast errors from the four preceding quarters, as detailed in Section 3.5. The underlying consensus and actual histories extend into 2020 for the earliest sample announcements. The accuracy-weighted composite is nonmissing for every firm-quarter in the final sample.

Table 2 reports descriptive statistics for the main variables.[17] Firm characteristics come from CRSP and Compustat. Quarter and announcement characteristics come from Compustat, CRSP, and I/B/E/S. Measures of the information environment come from I/B/E/S and the Thomson Reuters 13F Holdings database. Appendix A defines the controls. DataForSEO provides the LLM visibility

[14] Online Appendix C.1 describes the providers' origins and presents the evidence on Bloomberg's reported actuals.

[15] Larocque et al. (2026) follow a similar collection procedure for their 2002–2020 study. Bloomberg histories require ticker-by-ticker retrieval through Bloomberg Query Language (BQL) functions. The five-year limit on accessible consensus history determines the sample start.

[16] The S&P 1500 provides a feasible universe for ticker-by-ticker Bloomberg retrieval. Coverage declines outside the large- and mid-cap indices, and the design requires a consensus from all five providers.

[17] All continuous variables are winsorized at the 1st and 99th percentiles.

queries, issued through its LLM Responses API on May 28 and June 1, 2026 (Section 6.2), and the estimated monthly visits from Google organic search to the GenAI tools (Section 3.3 and Online Appendix C.5). The retail share of trading, the order flow and abnormal volume around announcements, and the pre-announcement spreads come from TAQ and the WRDS TAQ Intraday Indicators (Section 7.6 and Online Appendix C.4).

3.3 The GPT-Capability Regimes

Investors' use of GenAI is not observed, so variation in use across investors cannot be measured or estimated. The variation that is public and dated is the variation over time in ChatGPT's retrieval capability. I therefore divide the sample into four regimes using milestones in ChatGPT's publicly available retrieval capabilities, so that I can follow the premium as the capability evolves. The text-only months are the period in which the mechanism predicts no premium. The regimes are pre-ChatGPT (R0), text-only (R1, beginning November 30, 2022), browsing (R2, beginning September 27, 2023), and native search (R3, beginning October 31, 2024). I assign each announcement to the regime in effect on its announcement date, with R3 ending on December 31, 2025. R1 also includes a temporary browsing beta, so it is not a period uniformly without retrieval.[18] Browsing allows the model to retrieve current forecasts from multiple websites in response to a query. R3 marks the launch of ChatGPT search, which can search automatically when appropriate or let the user select search manually.[19] The post-scraping indicator $Post_q^{\text{Scr}}$ equals one for announcements on or after September 27, 2023.

When browsing returns in September 2023, ChatGPT receives 334 times as many Google-referred visits as Perplexity.[20] At the launch of ChatGPT search, it receives 12.8 times as many as the next-largest tracked tool. By December 2025, the ratio is 5.9 relative to Gemini. These comparisons establish ChatGPT's prominence among the tools that DataForSEO covers.

[18] A browsing beta begins rolling out to all Plus users in May 2023, is suspended on July 3, and returns on September 27, initially for paid subscribers. The R2 boundary marks this restoration, not browsing's first availability.

[19] Browsing is already integrated with other Plus tools in November 2023, without requiring users to switch models. The October 2024 boundary marks the launch of ChatGPT search, not the first integration of browsing into the main product. Search initially reaches Plus and Team users and the SearchGPT waitlist. Access expands to all logged-in users in December 2024.

[20] Figure OA1 in Online Appendix C.5 plots Google-referred visits to the GenAI tools covered by DataForSEO.

They do not measure total usage or investor adoption. The milestones also occur during a broader expansion of GenAI web retrieval.[21] I therefore use ChatGPT's milestones to organize the timing tests, without attributing changes across regimes exclusively to ChatGPT.

3.4 Dependent Variables

I infer the market's reliance on a consensus from the association between its implied surprise and announcement returns. Other things equal, returns should respond more strongly to surprises measured against a consensus that more closely reflects market expectations. The immediate-reaction tests use the three-day cumulative abnormal return $CAR_{[-1,1]}$. The trading-strategy test uses the four-day buy-and-hold abnormal return $BHAR_{[-2,1]}$.[22] For each window, I construct Fama–French–Carhart four-factor (FFC) and market-adjusted abnormal returns.[23]

3.5 Constructing the Accuracy-Weighted SUE

I construct the accuracy-weighted surprise by combining the five providers' surprises using their recent forecast accuracy for the firm. Let g index I/B/E/S, FactSet, Bloomberg, S&P Capital IQ, and Zacks. Provider g's standardized unexpected earnings for firm i in quarter q is $SUE^g_{i,q} = (Actual^g_{i,q} - Consensus^g_{i,q})/p_{i,q}$, where $p_{i,q}$ is the closing share price two trading days before the announcement. The consensus is the provider's end-of-quarter forecast, observed before the announcement. The actual is the earnings figure that the same provider reports. The accuracy-weighted composite is

$$SUE^{Acc}_{i,q} = \sum_g w^g_{i,q} SUE^g_{i,q}. \tag{1}$$

The equal-weighted benchmark, $SUE^{EW5}_{i,q}$, assigns each provider a weight of $1/5$. The I/B/E/S benchmark, $SUE^{IBES}_{i,q}$, uses that provider's surprise alone.

Combining surprises accommodates the providers' differing earnings definitions without

[21] Perplexity launches in December 2022, Bing Chat on February 7, 2023, and public access to Bard begins on March 21, 2023. These tools offer web retrieval before ChatGPT's September 2023 restoration of browsing. Bing Chat and Bard are absent from DataForSEO's traffic estimates. Microsoft renames Bing Chat as Copilot on November 15, 2023. Gemini Deep Research launches on December 11, 2024. Claude introduces web search on March 20, 2025, and extends it to all plans on May 27, 2025.

[22] The BHAR window begins at day -2 to include any pre-announcement leakage. Both windows end at day $+1$ to capture the next trading session's response to announcements after the market close.

[23] All returns are expressed in percent. Inferences are unchanged across the two adjustments. Tables presenting one adjustment report market-adjusted returns. The FFC counterparts are available on request.

selecting one provider's actual as the common target. Pairing each consensus with its own reported actual avoids introducing a mismatch by subtracting one provider's forecast from another's actual. An accounting adjustment cancels within a surprise only if it enters the forecast and actual by the same amount. The composite can be written as

$$SUE^{Acc}_{i,q} = \frac{\sum_g w^g_{i,q} Actual^g_{i,q} - \sum_g w^g_{i,q} Consensus^g_{i,q}}{p_{i,q}}. \tag{2}$$

Thus, the composite applies the same weights to forecasts and reported actuals. This identity does not harmonize providers' earnings definitions or remove the Bloomberg mismatch described in Section 3.1. The difference between the accuracy-weighted surprise and a benchmark surprise consequently contains both consensus and actual-earnings differences. The horse race in Section 5.2 does not separate these components. The predicted-surprise test in Section 5.1 isolates the consensus component and shows that it carries economic value on its own.

To construct the weights, I first calculate each provider's price-scaled absolute forecast error, $Err^g_{i,q} = |Actual^g_{i,q} - Consensus^g_{i,q}|/p_{i,q}$.[24] I calculate each provider's mean absolute forecast error, $MAFE^g_{i,q}$, over the four quarters preceding quarter q.[25] I define accuracy as $Acc^g_{i,q} = -MAFE^g_{i,q}$, so higher values indicate greater accuracy. The rolling window excludes the announcement quarter's forecast error.

I next standardize accuracy across the five providers within each firm-quarter:

$$Acc_z^g_{i,q} = \frac{Acc^g_{i,q} - \overline{Acc}_{i,q}}{\mathrm{sd}(Acc_{i,q})}.$$

I convert these standardized accuracies into weights using the softmax transform:

$$w^g_{i,q} = \frac{\exp(Acc_z^g_{i,q})}{\sum_h \exp(Acc_z^h_{i,q})}. \tag{3}$$

The weights are positive, sum to one, and increase with a provider's trailing accuracy relative to the

[24] I pair each provider's forecast with its own reported actual, following Larocque et al. (2026). For Bloomberg, the resulting error includes the accounting-basis difference discussed above. Errors are reported in percent. Multiplying all errors by 100 does not affect the standardized accuracies or the weights.

[25] When fewer than four errors are available, I average the observed errors within this window, dividing their sum by the number observed. Panel C of Table OA3 reports history completeness by regime. All five providers have complete four-quarter histories in 44 percent of pre-ChatGPT firm-quarters, compared with 88 to 92 percent in each post-ChatGPT regime.

others. When all five accuracies coincide, I assign each provider a weight of 0.2.[26]

This construction implements the forecast-combination intuition that provider accuracy can guide aggregation (Bates and Granger, 1969; Timmermann, 2006). It does not estimate the population-optimal weights,[27] which also depend on forecast-error covariances.[28] The four-quarter window balances recency against estimation noise, and updating it each quarter allows providers' weights to change. The average within-firm-quarter minimum and maximum weights are 0.029 and 0.420, respectively (untabulated), compared with the equal weight of 0.200. Thus, the construction departs from equal weighting without concentrating on a single provider. The correlation between SUE^{Acc} and SUE^{EW5} is approximately 0.82 (untabulated). Their imperfect correlation provides distinct variation for comparing their associations with announcement returns.

4 GenAI and Selective Reliance on Consensus Forecasts Across the Five FDPs

This section answers the first part of the question posed in the introduction, whether the market relies on each FDP's consensus selectively by its accuracy, provider by provider, and whether that selectivity strengthens after ChatGPT. Under Prediction 1, once GenAI makes each provider's track record readily retrievable, the market should weight a provider's surprise by how accurate that provider has recently been for the firm.

4.1 Selective Reliance on Individual FDPs After ChatGPT

The first test asks whether, after ChatGPT, the ERC on an individual FDP's surprise rises more steeply with that FDP's accuracy rank. Ranking the five FDPs within each firm-quarter by *ex ante* trailing MAFE (rank 1 = least, 5 = most accurate) and stacking the five provider observations for each firm-quarter, I estimate

$$CAR_{i,q} = \alpha + \beta\, SUE^{g}_{i,q} + \delta\, Rank^{g}_{i,q} + \gamma\left(SUE^{g}_{i,q} \times Rank^{g}_{i,q}\right) + \varepsilon_{i,q,g}, \tag{4}$$

[26] Online Appendix B.1 illustrates the construction for a hypothetical firm-quarter.

[27] Online Appendix B.2 shows that, when the provider-specific errors are uncorrelated, each provider's optimal weight is proportional to the inverse of its provider-specific error variance and that the combined forecast's expected squared error is below that of the most accurate single provider and no higher than that of equal weighting.

[28] Standardization makes the weights insensitive to the absolute size of the accuracy differences. Section 6.1 examines settings in which these differences offer greater potential benefits.

where γ is the ERC increment per one-rank accuracy gain.[29] Because rank is assigned within firm-quarter, identification comes from the same announcement return's differential sensitivity to the five providers' surprises. A firm- or time-level shock, including methodology drift common to all providers, shifts all five observations alike and cannot by itself generate a rank gradient. The design cannot show, however, whether the market's reliance on a given provider rises and falls with that provider's record.

The second test addresses this question directly. It fixes the provider and exploits cross-firm variation in how its accuracy rank changes around ChatGPT. I classify firms by the change in I/B/E/S's mean rank between the pre- and post-ChatGPT windows. The indicators $IBES\,Up_i$ and $IBES\,Down_i$ mark improvements and deteriorations of ≥ 2 positions. I then estimate the triple-interaction specification

$$\begin{aligned} CAR_{i,q} = \alpha + \beta_1 SUE^{IBES}_{i,q} + \beta_2 SUE^{IBES}_{i,q} \times Post_q \times IBES\,Up_i \\ + \beta_3 SUE^{IBES}_{i,q} \times Post_q \times IBES\,Down_i + Controls + \text{FE} + \varepsilon_{i,q}, \end{aligned} \tag{5}$$

with the lower-order terms included but not displayed.[30] Selective reliance predicts $\beta_3 < 0$. If the pre-ChatGPT market already overweighted its anchor, a gain in I/B/E/S's rank adds little, so $\beta_2 \approx 0$.

Table 3 reports both tests. After ChatGPT, the price reaction to a given surprise depends increasingly on which provider produced it. In Panel A, the per-rank ERC increment γ roughly doubles, from 0.306 before to 0.621 after, and the difference is significant ($p < 0.01$). The provider rows show the breadth of the pattern, with positive and significant post-ChatGPT per-rank increments for every provider except Zacks.[31] Estimated provider by provider, the response to each provider's own surprise rises after ChatGPT, significantly so for the four providers other than Bloomberg (Section 7.3). The rank selectivity is therefore a relative reweighting toward the more accurate providers, not a move away from the less accurate ones.

Panel B shows that, relative to the firms in which I/B/E/S holds its rank, the response to

[29] The earnings response coefficient (ERC) is the slope of announcement returns on the earnings surprise. A larger ERC means the market treats the surprise as more informative.

[30] The lower-order terms are $Post_q$ and the two-way interactions among SUE^{IBES}, $Post_q$, and the two rank-change indicators. The indicators themselves are firm-level and are absorbed by the firm fixed effects.

[31] Versions of Panel A estimated cell by cell, one regression per provider–rank pair, in both absolute-value and signed form, yield the same inferences (untabulated).

the I/B/E/S surprise weakens significantly where I/B/E/S *loses* rank (the post-ChatGPT triple interaction for I/B/E/S-down firms ranges from -2.3 to -2.8 across specifications, $p < 0.05$) and does not change significantly where it gains. The point estimates for the firms in which it gains rank are about half of those in which it loses rank. The baseline I/B/E/S ERC rises after ChatGPT, consistent with the decline in surprise magnitudes documented in Section 5.1. The triple interaction therefore measures a relative decline. This asymmetry is consistent with a pre-ChatGPT market that already overweighted I/B/E/S.

4.2 Analyst Herding Toward the I/B/E/S Consensus

Because the partition of Table 3, Panel B, rests on the change in I/B/E/S's rank, attenuation alone could lower the I/B/E/S ERC where I/B/E/S loses rank, so a measure of reliance that does not rest on an ERC is needed. Analysts' forecast revisions provide such a measure, one that comes from the forecasting process itself. Each time a sell-side analyst revises a forecast, the analyst chooses how far to move toward the prevailing consensus (Clement and Tse, 2005). The strength of that tendency indicates how much weight the analyst assigns to the consensus as a signal. If the post-ChatGPT information environment devalues a degraded default benchmark, analysts should herd toward the I/B/E/S consensus less in the firms in which I/B/E/S loses accuracy rank in Panel B, because those are the firms in which the market discounts it.[32] The regressions use 122,001 quarterly EPS forecast revisions for the sample firms over 2019–2025, and *Herding* equals one when the revised forecast falls between the analyst's own prior and the prevailing I/B/E/S consensus. I regress the indicator on $Post_q$ and its interactions with the $IBESUp_i$ and $IBESDown_i$ indicators of Table 3, with the firm and event controls of Equation (5), the analyst controls of Clement (1999), analyst and firm or analyst×firm fixed effects, revision-year fixed effects, and fixed effects for twenty ventiles of the distance between the analyst's prior and the consensus.[33]

Table 4 reports the estimates. After ChatGPT, herding toward the consensus falls in the firms in which I/B/E/S loses rank relative to the firms in which I/B/E/S holds its rank. The $Post \times IBESDown$

[32] I/B/E/S is the only provider for which forecast-level data are available to me. The test therefore asks whether analysts' reliance on the I/B/E/S consensus changes after ChatGPT, not whether analysts substitute toward the consensus forecasts of the other FDPs.

[33] Online Appendix C.2 describes the revision sample, the prevailing consensus, and the specification in full.

coefficient is -4.8 percentage points (t = -2.62), about 15 percent of the 32-percent base rate, while the $Post \times IBES\,Up$ coefficient is positive and insignificant. This decline is the same one-sided pattern as the market's reweighting in Table 3.

The decline is already present in the text-only regime, whereas the market-level premium of Section 5.3 appears only with browsing. The difference is consistent with the analysts' position in the information environment. Sell-side analysts typically have terminal access to the other FDPs' consensus forecasts, so acquisition is not the binding cost for them. An analyst could already use a text-only model to evaluate each provider's quality from its past performance for the firm and weight the surprises by that assessment. The text-only regime is therefore the period in which the mechanism predicts no market-level premium, and it carries no such prediction for the analyst test. This evidence supports the market-level results but does not identify the mechanism on its own.

4.3 An Alternative Proxy for the Quality of the Consensus Forecast: Predictive Value

Trailing accuracy is one proxy for the quality of a consensus forecast. *Predictive value*, how closely the consensus anticipates the firm's future street earnings, is an alternative proxy. If the post-ChatGPT selectivity reflects a general preference for consensus quality, and is not an artifact of the trailing-accuracy construction, the same pattern should appear on this proxy as well, as Prediction 1 anticipates. The test proceeds in two stages.

The first stage measures predictive value for each firm-quarter from the firm's own history of I/B/E/S consensus forecasts and street actuals. For a source quarter s, the year-ahead pair is the I/B/E/S consensus for quarter s and the I/B/E/S street actual for quarter $s+4$, the same fiscal quarter one year later. The window $S_{i,q}$ holds up to the twenty most recent source quarters whose year-ahead actuals are announced before the start of the calendar quarter in which firm i announces quarter q. I require at least twelve such quarters. For each firm-quarter, I regress the year-ahead actual on the consensus over the window by ordinary least squares.[34] The intercept $a_{i,q}$ and the slope $b_{i,q}$ are fitted on the window, and $e_{i,s}$ is the error of source quarter s,

$$Actual^{IBES}_{i,s+4} = a_{i,q} + b_{i,q}\, Consensus^{IBES}_{i,s} + e_{i,s}, \qquad s \in S_{i,q}. \tag{6}$$

[34]The fitted slope is negative in 20.8 percent of the windows, and the R-squared is below 0.05 in 31.2 percent.

The residual $\hat{e}_{i,s}$ is the year-ahead actual net of its fitted value. Predictive value is one minus the ratio of the window's summed absolute residuals to its summed absolute year-ahead actuals,

$$Predictive\ Value_{i,q}^{IBES} = 1 - \frac{\sum_{s \in S_{i,q}} \left| \hat{e}_{i,s} \right|}{\sum_{s \in S_{i,q}} \left| Actual_{i,s+4}^{IBES} \right|}, \tag{7}$$

with the ratio winsorized at the 1st and 99th percentiles. The measure covers 22,364 of the 23,833 firm-quarters.

The second stage tests whether the ERC on the I/B/E/S surprise rises with predictive value and whether this gradient steepens after ChatGPT. I estimate

$$\begin{aligned} CAR_{i,q} = \alpha + \beta_1 SUE_{i,q}^{IBES} + \beta_2 SUE_{i,q}^{IBES} \times Post_q + \beta_3 SUE_{i,q}^{IBES} \times Predictive\ Value_{i,q}^{IBES} \\ + \beta_4 SUE_{i,q}^{IBES} \times Predictive\ Value_{i,q}^{IBES} \times Post_q + Controls + \text{FE} + \varepsilon_{i,q}, \end{aligned} \tag{8}$$

with the lower-order terms included but not displayed. The regression includes the firm and event controls of Equation (5) and firm and year fixed effects. The coefficient β_1 is the pre-ChatGPT ERC at zero predictive value, and β_2 is its post-ChatGPT change. The coefficient β_3 is the pre-ChatGPT gradient of the ERC in predictive value, and β_4 is its post-ChatGPT increment. The coefficient of interest is β_4. A second version replaces $Post_q$ in every term with the indicators of the three GPT-capability regimes after ChatGPT's release (text-only, browsing, and native search), so that each regime carries its own increment.[35]

Table 5 reports the estimates. Before ChatGPT, the ERC gradient on predictive value is already strongly positive ($\beta_3 = 2.76$, $t = 4.70$). Firms whose consensus predicts well are known to have higher ERCs (Collins and Kothari, 1989), so the identified claim is the post-ChatGPT increment, $\beta_4 = 3.11$ ($t = 3.53$). The increment exceeds the pre-period gradient, so the slope more than doubles after ChatGPT. Because the measure is close to a firm's earnings predictability, the increment is also consistent with an explanation that does not involve GenAI, such as the 2022 shift in discount rates. Across the GPT-capability regimes the increment is insignificant in the text-only regime, significant under browsing, and largest under native search, a profile consistent with a forecast track record that becomes retrievable once the model can browse. The regime profile is descriptive, and the pooled increment is the formal test.

[35] Online Appendix C.3 describes the measure and two alternative explanations in full.

5 GenAI and the Accuracy-Weighted Synthesis Across FDPs

This section answers the second part of the question posed in the introduction, whether the provider-level selectivity of Section 4 carries into the aggregation that prices reflect. The weighting analyses operate on accuracy, not on the predictive value of Section 4.3, because accuracy is realized at every announcement and varies firm-quarter by firm-quarter.[36] The expectation against which the market judges an announcement is an aggregation of the consensus forecasts across FDPs, and the two benchmarks anchor on the I/B/E/S consensus or weight the five providers equally. The alternative weights each provider's surprise by its recent accuracy for the firm. This shift is the second part of Prediction 1 and the stronger claim, because a market can favor one accurate provider without combining across providers at all. The test is whether announcement returns respond to the accuracy-weighted surprise over and above their response to the two benchmarks.

5.1 Validating the Accuracy-Weighted Construct

Weighting by trailing accuracy is informative only if a provider's accuracy persists. Panel A of Table 6 reports the persistence of the providers' accuracy ranks. Provider ranks persist (Spearman $\rho = 0.71$), with the least- and most-accurate providers retaining their ranks 76 and 65 percent of the time, roughly three to four times the uniform baseline.[37] Figure 2 compares the accuracy of the three surprise measures. Out of sample, SUE^{Acc} has the smallest mean absolute error of the three in both the pre- and post-ChatGPT periods.[38]

If accuracy persists, the difference between the accuracy-weighted and a benchmark consensus, known before the announcement, should also earn a return after it. I measure this difference as

[36] Predictive value and accuracy largely measure the same underlying quality at different horizons, with a cross-firm correlation of 0.72 (Online Appendix C.3). Accuracy therefore captures most of what predictive value measures.

[37] Part of this persistence is mechanical, because adjacent four-quarter windows share three quarters. Online Appendix B.3 shows that the weights are invariant to any change in accuracy common to the five providers, so an economy-wide improvement in forecast quality leaves them unchanged. Their relative pattern is stable across the three post-ChatGPT regimes after a step down in Bloomberg's share of most-accurate firm-quarters at ChatGPT's release (see Panel C of Table OA3 for details). Tilting the weights toward accurate providers loses no detectable predictive content for year-ahead earnings and cash flows.

[38] In Panel (a), surprise magnitudes decline over the sample for all three measures. Because ERCs are concave in surprise magnitude, the tests below rest on the contrast between composites estimated on the same announcements and not on the level of any loading. In a pricing model in which the market's expectation is a convex combination of the accuracy-weighted and benchmark consensus levels, the accuracy premium equals $\theta(2\omega - 1)$, where ω is the market's relative reliance on the accuracy-weighted synthesis (Online Appendix B.3). The premium therefore measures how the market uses the providers, not how accurate they are.

the *predicted surprise*

$$Pred.Surp._{i,q}^{X} = \frac{Consensus_{i,q}^{Acc} - Consensus_{i,q}^{X}}{p_{i,q}}, \qquad X \in \{EW5, IBES\}, \tag{9}$$

where $Consensus_{i,q}^{Acc} = \sum_g w_{i,q}^{g} Consensus_{i,q}^{g}$ is the consensus EPS built with the weights of Equation (3), $Consensus_{i,q}^{X}$ is the corresponding benchmark consensus, and $p_{i,q}$ is the closing share price two trading days before the announcement, as in Section 3.5. Panel B of Table 6 reports its trading value. The standardized predicted surprise forecasts the four-day BHAR in all four columns ($p < 0.01$). A long–short portfolio on the quintiles of the predicted surprise earns 0.63–0.73 percent per announcement against the equal-weighted benchmark and 1.35 percent against I/B/E/S ($p < 0.01$).[39]

5.2 The Accuracy Premium: Horse-Race Tests

With the construct validated, I test the accuracy-weighted composite SUE^{Acc} against the two benchmarks, the equal-weighted composite SUE^{EW5} and the I/B/E/S-only consensus SUE^{IBES}. The pooled specification is

$$\begin{aligned} CAR_{i,q} = \alpha + \beta_1 SUE_{i,q}^{Acc} + \beta_2 SUE_{i,q}^{X} + \beta_3 SUE_{i,q}^{Acc} \times Post_q \\ + \beta_4 SUE_{i,q}^{X} \times Post_q + Controls + \text{FE} + \varepsilon_{i,q}, \end{aligned} \tag{10}$$

for $X \in \{EW5, IBES\}$. The pre-period accuracy premium is the contrast $\beta_1 - \beta_2$. Its post-minus-pre change, $\beta_3 - \beta_4$, is the central test of Prediction 1. The dependent variable is the three-day CAR under both risk adjustments, market-adjusted and FFC four-factor, and year fixed effects are for the year of quarter q.[40]

Table 7 reports the horse-race estimates. After ChatGPT, the market tilts toward the accuracy-weighted composite at the expense of both benchmarks. In Panel A (equal-weighted

[39]The tests min-max standardize the predicted surprise to the unit interval. Table 2 reports the standard deviations of the two standardized predicted surprises, 0.116 and 0.109. Per standard deviation, the market-adjusted slopes of Panel B imply BHAR increments of about 0.29 and 0.37 percentage points against the equal-weighted and I/B/E/S benchmarks. The quintiles are set at the 20th and 80th percentiles of the predicted surprise in the pooled sample, and the long–short return is the difference in the BHAR between the top and bottom quintiles, from a regression on a top-quintile indicator with firm-clustered standard errors and without fixed effects or controls.

[40]Although SUE^{Acc} and the benchmark SUE^{X} are correlated by construction ($\rho \approx 0.82$ for $X = EW5$), the identifying quantity is the contrast $\beta_1 - \beta_2$, whose sampling variance is a property of the estimand, not of the horse-race parameterization. Because every test in this section uses the contrast, the inflated standard errors of the individual slopes do not affect the inference.

benchmark), the pre-ChatGPT accuracy premium is statistically indistinguishable from zero, consistent with the equal-weighted composite already capturing the pre-period information set. After ChatGPT the premium turns sharply positive, as the accuracy-weighted slope rises while the equal-weighted slope falls. The falling benchmark slope does not mean the equal-weighted signal loses information, because in a horse race each slope is conditional on the other measure. The formal test is the pooled interaction contrast, which estimates the premium's post-minus-pre change at 2.401 ($p < 0.01$) under the market-adjusted CAR and 2.584 under the FFC four-factor abnormal return.

Panel B repeats the test against the I/B/E/S benchmark. There the pre-ChatGPT accuracy premium is negative but statistically insignificant. The post-ChatGPT premium rises to 2.049 ($p < 0.01$), a post-minus-pre change of 2.672 ($p < 0.01$) under the market-adjusted CAR and 2.688 under the FFC adjustment. The results are consistent when $Post^{\text{Scr}}$ replaces *Post*, with the post-period starting at the onset of GPT browsing, which the regime estimates of Section 5.3 make plausible (see Panel A of Table 12 in Section 7.1 for details).

The comparison with I/B/E/S mixes two gains, because a composite of several providers gains over I/B/E/S from pooling them as well as from weighting them by accuracy. The equal-weighted benchmark isolates the second only when its surprises share one earnings basis. The five-FDP benchmark carries Bloomberg's surprise, whose actual is on another basis (Section 3.1). The four-provider comparison with equal weighting is therefore the one that isolates weighting by accuracy. Without Bloomberg, the accuracy-weighted composite is priced above I/B/E/S before ChatGPT and below the equal-weighted composite of the same four providers, so the pooled tests of Table 7 rest on the post-ChatGPT change in the five-FDP premium, not on the level of the premium (Section 7.5).

Panel B of the table on the classical prominence proxies in Section 6.2 splits the change against the equal-weighted benchmark, with the post-period starting at browsing, at the median of firm size and of analyst coverage. The change holds in the smaller and less-followed half of the sample. It is 2.45 ($t = 2.18$) in firms below the median size and 0.72 above it, and 3.08 ($t = 2.57$) in firms below the median analyst coverage and 0.11 above it. The pattern is consistent with retrieval

contributing most to the premium where fewer analysts leave the FDPs' consensus forecasts for investors to collect themselves.

Panel (b) of Figure 2 plots the accuracy of the composite and of the two benchmarks before and after ChatGPT. A more accurate composite proxies better for the market's expectation and would earn a higher slope for that reason alone. Its accuracy advantage over each benchmark, however, changes little from the pre- to the post-ChatGPT period, so a better proxy cannot explain a premium that widens. The two periods differ in one input to the composite. Complete four-quarter windows for all five providers are rarer before ChatGPT (Section 3.5), so the pre-period weights rest on fewer quarters. A noisier pre-period composite would lower its pre-period loading and raise the measured change.

The magnitudes are economically considerable. The post-ChatGPT increments of 2.4 and 2.7 percentage points are 80 to 90 percent of the pre-ChatGPT ERC on the I/B/E/S surprise estimated on its own (Section 7.3). Scaled by a typical tilt instead of a full percentage point of surprise, the magnitudes are more modest. The counterfactual is a market that relies equally on the accuracy-weighted and the equal-weighted consensus, under which the premium is zero.[41] Relative to it, a one-standard-deviation tilt of roughly 0.29 percent of price (implied by the standard deviations of Table 2 and the correlation of Section 3.5) moves the three-day CAR by about 0.2 percentage points, half the post-ChatGPT premium times the tilt, or roughly three percent of the CAR's standard deviation.

5.3 The Accuracy Premium Across GPT-Capability Regimes

The pooled contrast of Table 7 dates the shift only to the ChatGPT boundary. If the premium reflects the GenAI-mediated synthesis of Prediction 1, it should strengthen as the tools' retrieval capabilities expand, because retrieval is the step of synthesis that the tests identify (Section 2.2). I therefore re-estimate the horse race of Equation (10) within the four GPT-capability regimes of Section 3.3.

The text-only regime is also the period in which the mechanism predicts no premium. If the

[41] Online Appendix B.3 derives this counterfactual from the pricing model, in which the premium is zero at equal reliance.

premium reflects attention to AI, sentiment, or any other shock coincident with ChatGPT's release, it should already appear in the text-only months, and if it reflects retrieval, it cannot. This test has three limitations. It rules out a discrete shock at the release date, not a gradual process that happens to accelerate in late 2023. It does not rule out shocks that coincide with the browsing boundary itself. The cross-sectional and visibility tests of Section 6 address those shocks, because a shock unrelated to retrieval would not concentrate in the firms whose forecasts the models can retrieve. It is also partial, because Perplexity, Bing Chat, and Bard answer with web retrieval during the text-only regime and a ChatGPT browsing beta runs from May to early July 2023 before it is withdrawn.

Table 8 reports the horse race regime by regime, against the equal-weighted five-FDP benchmark in Panel A and against the I/B/E/S benchmark in Panel B. In the pre-ChatGPT and text-only regimes the accuracy premium is statistically indistinguishable from zero on both comparisons. Under browsing it turns positive on both, at 2.43 ($p < 0.05$) in Panel A and 1.52, which remains insignificant, in Panel B. Under native search it is significant on both, at 2.55 ($p < 0.05$) in Panel A and 4.91 ($p < 0.01$) in Panel B. The premium is thus detectable only once the model can retrieve forecasts (see Figure 3, Panel (a)).[42]

Within the post-period, the rise is less precisely dated than its existence. A regression with both boundaries does not separate the change at ChatGPT's release from the change at the onset of GPT browsing (Section 7.1). The regime estimates of Table 8, not the regression, place the premium in the browsing and native-search regimes.[43]

6 Cross-Sectional Tests and LLM Visibility

If the premium reflects GenAI-mediated synthesis, it should be larger under the two conditions of Prediction 2. First, the market has more reason to synthesize where the gain from weighting the providers by accuracy is largest, that is, where the providers disagree about the surprise and where their treatment of nonrecurring items differs most. A premium that concentrates in those

[42] In yearly estimates on the long panels of the three providers with the longest histories (I/B/E/S, Capital IQ, and Zacks, from 2005) and of four providers (with FactSet, from 2017), neither of which includes Bloomberg, the premium against equal weighting is never significantly positive from 2005 to 2023 (untabulated). It is largest in 2024 in both panels. Its largest value before 2024 is 1.67.

[43] Section 7.2 examines five developments other than GenAI retrieval that coincide with the regime boundaries.

firm-quarters is one that the market earns by synthesizing, not a uniform shift in the earnings response. Second, a model synthesizes only the consensus forecasts that it retrieves, so the premium should be larger in the firms for which it retrieves more consensus forecasts from more sources, and only once it can retrieve. A shock unrelated to synthesis would respect neither condition.

6.1 Cross-Sectional Tests: Disagreement Across FDPs and the Magnitude of Special Items

The regime estimates of Table 8 place the accuracy premium in the browsing and native-search regimes, so the cross-sectional tests replace the post-ChatGPT indicator $Post_q$ with the post-scraping indicator $Post_q^{\text{Scr}}$ of Section 3.3. I re-estimate the horse-race specification in Equation (10) within the below- and above-median halves of two partitions. (i) *Concurrent cross-FDP SUE dispersion* is the interquartile range of the five FDPs' SUE for the same firm-quarter, and accuracy weighting has the greatest scope to be selective among providers when this dispersion is high. (ii) *Special-items magnitude* is the absolute value of special items scaled by market capitalization two trading days before the announcement. Because FDPs differ in their treatment of unexpected charges and gains, cross-FDP disagreement over what belongs in street earnings should be largest where such items are economically material.

Table 9 reports the partition-by-partition estimates.[44] The post-scraping change in the premium is significant only in the predicted half of each partition (see Figure 4). In Panel A (cross-FDP dispersion), the change is 2.211 ($p < 0.05$) against the equal-weighted benchmark and 2.427 ($p < 0.01$) against I/B/E/S in the high-disagreement subsample, versus insignificant estimates in the low-disagreement subsample. The equal-weighted comparison requires a caveat, because the low-disagreement point estimate is close in magnitude to its high-disagreement counterpart and differs mainly in precision. The partition separates cleanly only against I/B/E/S, for which the low-disagreement estimate turns negative. In that subsample the level of the premium is negative and precisely estimated, because before the onset of GPT browsing its announcement returns load about 4.8 times as heavily on the I/B/E/S surprise as on the accuracy-weighted surprise. This loading

[44] A variant of Table 9 that uses the post-ChatGPT boundary in place of the post-scraping indicator and adds a median split on LLM visibility yields similar inferences, with the premium concentrating in the high half of each partition (untabulated).

is consistent either with the I/B/E/S surprise being the better proxy for the market's expectation when the providers agree or with a small number of firm-quarters with a considerable gap between the two surprises identifying the contrast.

Panel B (special items) requires no such qualification. The premium change is 2.518 ($p < 0.05$) against the equal-weighted benchmark and 3.638 ($p < 0.01$) against I/B/E/S in the high-special-items subsample, versus point estimates of the opposite sign in the low-special-items subsample. The two partitions test different parts of the mechanism. The dispersion partition tests selectivity, which has the most scope where the five FDPs disagree most about the size of the surprise. The special-items partition tests integration, which has the most scope where their methodological choices most affect it.

6.2 LLM Visibility and Effective Synthesis

A precondition for the premium is that GenAI retrieves the firm's forecasts for the investor who asks, because the model cannot synthesize forecasts it cannot retrieve. The accessibility clause of Prediction 2 turns this precondition into a testable restriction. The premium should be stronger in firms whose forecasts the models retrieve than in firms whose forecasts they do not. This section introduces *LLM visibility*, a direct measure of that acquisition. For each firm, I query a browsing-enabled model, ChatGPT (GPT-4o with web search), three times for the next-quarter consensus EPS through the DataForSEO LLM Responses API, which returns each answer together with links to the sources it cites. The measure is the number of these source citations, repeats included, averaged over the three queries. High-visibility firms are those above the cross-firm median, and firms at the median join the low group.[45]

The measure captures realized retrieval, not retrieval capability. It is a single firm-level classification, taken at one point in time with the model then available and applied to every regime. It proxies for retrievability in the browsing and native-search regimes under the assumption that the set of websites carrying a firm's forecasts is stable over the sample. To the extent that drift

[45] A response with more source citations draws more on the websites that carry the firm's forecasts. Online Appendix A.1 describes the query and reports the providers that the cited sites name as the sources of their estimates. The queries run on May 28, 2026 for 1,304 firms (3,912 responses) and on June 1 for 56 firms (168 responses), three per firm, after the end of the sample period. Eleven of the June firms are also among the May firms.

in that set is unrelated to announcement returns, it adds classification error, which attenuates the estimated gap and does not produce it. The measure is nonetheless a dimension of firm prominence distinct from the classical prominence proxies, as the next test shows.

Table 10 reports the overlap of the high-visibility half with the top halves of firm size, analyst coverage, and institutional ownership (Panel A) and a horse race of the four measures against each benchmark (Panels B and C). LLM visibility shares little with the classical prominence proxies. The overlap between the high-visibility half and the top half of each proxy is 0.47 to 0.51 in either direction, near the 0.50 that independent median splits imply, whereas the overlap between the top halves of firm size and analyst coverage is 0.80. In the horse race, which includes every measure's high-group triple interaction in one regression, LLM visibility's gap survives, at 3.17 against the equal-weighted benchmark ($p < 0.10$) and 5.84 against I/B/E/S ($p < 0.01$). Firm size carries no gap against either benchmark. Analyst coverage carries none at the five-percent level. Institutional ownership carries one only against the equal-weighted benchmark, and only at the ten-percent level.

A second test combines the visibility split with the regime timing in a difference-in-differences design. If acquisition is a precondition for synthesis, the high-minus-low visibility gap in the premium should be absent while retrieval is impossible and should emerge once it becomes possible. I estimate, separately within each GPT-capability regime r,

$$\begin{aligned} CAR_{i,q} = \alpha + \beta_1 SUE^{Acc}_{i,q} + \beta_2 SUE^{X}_{i,q} + \beta_3 SUE^{Acc}_{i,q} \times High\,Visibility_i \\ + \beta_4 SUE^{X}_{i,q} \times High\,Visibility_i + \gamma High\,Visibility_i + Controls + \text{FE} + \varepsilon_{i,q}, \end{aligned} \tag{11}$$

with the firm and event controls of Equation (10), firm and year-quarter fixed effects for quarter q, and standard errors two-way clustered by firm and calendar year. The low-visibility premium is $\beta_1 - \beta_2$, the high-visibility premium is $(\beta_1 + \beta_3) - (\beta_2 + \beta_4)$, and the high-minus-low gap within the regime is $Premium_r^{\text{High}-\text{Low}} = \beta_{3,r} - \beta_{4,r}$.

Table 11 reports the estimates of Equation (11) regime by regime. The gap $Premium_r^{\text{High}-\text{Low}}$ is statistically insignificant at the five-percent level in the pre-ChatGPT and text-only regimes (R0,

R1), the difference-in-differences analog of flat pre-trends.[46] Once the model can browse, the gap emerges. It is 2.7 to 3.0 in the browsing regime (R2, $p < 0.05$), then 3.1 to 4.2 under native search (R3), significant against I/B/E/S ($p < 0.01$) but only marginally so against the equal-weighted benchmark. The premium is not confined to high-visibility firms once native search arrives (the low-visibility premium against I/B/E/S in R3 is 3.05, $p < 0.01$), but the gap between the two groups opens only with retrieval (see Figure 3, Panels (b) and (c)). The premium thus concentrates in firms whose forecasts are visible to the model, and only once the model can retrieve them, a timing consistent with acquisition being a precondition for synthesis.

The regime timing also weighs against the residual concern that LLM visibility merely proxies for firm prominence. Because the visibility split is applied to every regime, a prominence account resting on a static firm characteristic would predict a premium gap in the pre-ChatGPT and text-only regimes as well, whereas the gap opens only when retrieval arrives.

7 Additional Tests

This section examines six concerns that the main tests leave open: the timing of the premium within the post-period, the developments at the regime boundaries, the response to each provider's own surprise, whether the premium reflects cheaper access to more forecasts, the results without Bloomberg, and the investors who synthesize. Table 12 summarizes the estimates in five panels.

7.1 The Timing of the Premium Within the Post-Period

Panel A of Table 12 tests whether the rise of the premium dates from the onset of GPT browsing in September 2023 instead of ChatGPT's release. Starting the post-period at browsing lowers the change in the premium, to 2.48 ($p < 0.01$) against I/B/E/S and 1.77 ($p < 0.05$) against the equal-weighted benchmark. A regression with both boundaries separates neither change from zero at the five-percent level, whereas their sum is significant.

[46] A formal pre-trend test that stacks the two pre-retrieval regimes finds the change in the gap from R0 to R1 statistically indistinguishable from zero ($p = 0.22$ against I/B/E/S and 0.16 against the equal-weighted benchmark; untabulated).

7.2 Concurrent Events Around GPT Regime Phase-In

Five developments coincide with the regime boundaries. First, the SEC's December 2022 update to its guidance on non-GAAP measures cannot be separated from the release. At the five-percent level, four of the ten provider pairs change how often their street actuals disagree at the release, and none at browsing.[47] Second, the providers' own AI tools arrive inside the post-period, Capital IQ's ChatIQ twelve days into native search, so part of the largest step against I/B/E/S may come from that tool. Third, analyst coverage rises at the browsing and native-search boundaries, by 0.12 and 0.33 analysts within firms (untabulated), and cannot be separated from the regime timing. Fourth, the other GenAI tools add web retrieval on the dates that Section 3.3 reports, and those that DataForSEO tracks together draw fewer visits from Google search than ChatGPT in every month from October 2022 to December 2025.[48] Fifth, the FDPs' consensus forecasts do not converge on I/B/E/S, with median absolute gaps to the I/B/E/S consensus between 1.08 and 1.58 basis points of price for FactSet, Bloomberg, and Capital IQ in every regime (untabulated).[49] The visibility gap of Section 6.2, which opens only when retrieval arrives, separates the first three developments from retrieval.

7.3 The Market Reaction to Each FDP's Own Surprise

The rank selectivity of Section 4.1 could reflect a weaker reaction after ChatGPT to the less accurate providers, or to every provider. Panel B of Table 12 reports the ERC on each provider's own surprise. The ERC rises after ChatGPT for every provider, significantly for four of the five, by 0.68 for FactSet to 1.45 for Zacks. Bloomberg's increment of 0.18 is insignificant, consistent with the noise that its earnings basis adds to its surprise. The selectivity is therefore a relative reweighting.

[47] Panel B of Table OA3 reports the share of firm-quarters in which each pair of providers publishes different street actuals by GPT-capability regime.

[48] Figure OA1 in Online Appendix C.5 plots the monthly visits of each tool.

[49] The gap is the absolute difference between a provider's consensus and the I/B/E/S consensus, scaled by the price that scales SUE, in basis points.

7.4 Cheaper Access to More Forecasts? Evidence from the Crowdsourced Consensus at Estimize

The premium could reflect cheaper access to more forecasts instead of accuracy-weighted synthesis. A GenAI query retrieves forecasts beyond the five providers, such as the Estimize crowd consensus, so the market after ChatGPT may be using more sources instead of weighting the five providers by accuracy. The two explanations make opposite predictions in a race against the crowd consensus itself, a free consensus of many contributors outside the five providers. If cheaper access drives the premium, the crowd consensus carries the post-ChatGPT reaction and the composite earns no premium over it. If accuracy weighting drives the premium, the composite earns a premium over the crowd consensus, and the premium appears when retrieval arrives. Panel C of Table 12 reports the race under native search and its change from the pre-ChatGPT regime. Under native search the composite earns a premium of 5.07 ($t = 2.38$) over the crowd consensus, 5.16 ($t = 2.81$) more than before ChatGPT. Cheaper access to more forecasts does not explain the premium.[50]

7.5 The Results Without Bloomberg

Bloomberg's reported actual follows a different earnings basis from its consensus, so the five-FDP composites could owe their results to that noise. Panel D of Table 12 repeats the pooled horse race without Bloomberg. The post-ChatGPT change in the premium is then 3.24 against I/B/E/S and 4.56 against the equal-weighted composite of the other four providers, each significant at the five-percent level despite larger standard errors than the five-FDP estimates. The rise in the premium therefore does not rest on Bloomberg's surprise.

7.6 Which Investors Benefit More from GenAI

If one investor group performs the synthesis, the premium should concentrate in the firms that this group holds or trades. Panel E of Table 12 reports the high-minus-low difference in the change in the premium in median splits of the retail share of trading, institutional ownership, and analyst coverage. The change in the premium does not differ significantly between high-

[50] Jame et al. (2016) find Estimize forecasts informative about earnings. The test has two limits. The Estimize firm-quarters are 58 percent of the sample and belong to larger, more closely followed firms. On that subsample only the premium against I/B/E/S rises significantly from the pre-ChatGPT regime to native search, so the test bears on the I/B/E/S comparison.

and low-retail-share firms or between high- and low-institutional-ownership firms. Against the equal-weighted benchmark, it is larger in firms that fewer analysts follow. No investor group's order flow, trading volume, or fund holdings shift toward the accuracy-weighted surprise against both benchmarks at the five-percent level.[51] Nor does the response of pre-announcement bid–ask spreads to the accuracy tilt in high-visibility firms change detectably once browsing arrives. The premium is therefore consistent with synthesis by whichever investors set announcement prices. The null is also what the field evidence on professionals' use of AI tools predicts. In interviews and surveys, sell-side analysts describe adopting AI mainly to improve their efficiency, with the tools absorbing routine processing (Christ et al., 2025; Kimbrough et al., 2026). On the buy side, nearly all fund managers in an industry survey report using GenAI in their work, mostly for summarizing documents, general research, and writing (AIMA, 2025). In a survey of hedge fund managers, most funds use GenAI tools for investment purposes, and almost all of the adopters use them to process data and text such as earnings calls (Sheng et al., 2026).

8 Conclusion

The consensus against which investors evaluate earnings depends on how they combine forecasts from competing providers. I find that, after ChatGPT's release, the market places greater relative weight on more accurate providers while continuing to respond to the other providers' forecasts. Announcement returns also become more closely aligned with an accuracy-weighted synthesis relative to the I/B/E/S and equal-weighted benchmarks. Sell-side analysts herd less toward I/B/E/S where its relative accuracy declines. Differences between the accuracy-weighted consensus and the two benchmarks, observable before the announcement, predict announcement returns.

The timing and cross-sectional patterns support a role for retrieval in this shift. The accuracy premium increases in the browsing and native-search regimes, with the largest point estimates under native search. Within these regimes, the premium concentrates in firms whose forecasts receive more source citations in the model's responses. It is also larger in firm-quarters with large special items and, relative to I/B/E/S, greater disagreement across providers. These patterns are consistent

[51] Online Appendix C.4 reports these trading tests, which are untabulated.

with lower retrieval costs making synthesis more accessible, particularly where distinguishing among providers offers greater benefits.

The findings contribute to three related literatures. First, they extend research on consensus construction (Bochkay et al., 2022; Larocque et al., 2026) by showing that the market's reliance on competing providers changes with the information environment. Second, they contribute to research on GenAI in capital markets (e.g., Bertomeu et al., 2025; Cheng et al., 2025; Liu and Subasi, 2026) by providing evidence consistent with synthesis across providers as a channel linking GenAI to prices. Third, they apply the disclosure-processing-cost framework of Blankespoor et al. (2020) to the recurring task of retrieving competing forecasts, assessing their accuracy, and combining them.

Several caveats are warranted. The accuracy-weighted composite is a proxy for investors' synthesis. The tests do not recover the weights investors actually use. LLM visibility is measured after the sample period, and changes in model behavior over time can limit its correspondence with historical retrieval accessibility (Chen et al., 2024). The capability regimes also coincide with changes in other GenAI tools and the broader information environment. Their timing therefore does not isolate retrieval's causal effect or attribute the shift to a particular tool. Finally, the ownership and trading tests do not identify which investors perform the synthesis.

The broader implication is that the consensus reflected in prices can evolve with the technology available to investors. Even when competing forecasts are public, their use is contingent on the cost of retrieving them and assessing their relative accuracy. Lowering that cost can change the earnings benchmark against which the market evaluates news.

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Appendix A: Variable Definitions

Variable	Definition	Source
Panel A. Across-FDP firm-quarter outcome and surprise variables		
$CAR^{m}_{i,q,[-1,1]}$, $BHAR^{m}_{i,q,[-2,1]}$	For the adjustment m, market (*Mkt*: the daily return $r_{i,t}$ minus r^{M}_{t}, the CRSP value-weighted index return on day t) or Fama–French–Carhart four-factor (*FFC*: FF3+UMD, with loadings estimated over $[-260,-11]$), the three-day cumulative abnormal return over $[-1,1]$ (*CAR*) and the four-day buy-and-hold abnormal return over $[-2,1]$ (*BHAR*) around firm i's quarter-q announcement, in percent.	CRSP
$SUE^{g}_{i,q}$	For provider g, one of I/B/E/S (*IBES*), FactSet, Bloomberg, S&P Capital IQ (*CapIQ*), and Zacks, the standardized unexpected earnings $(Actual^{g}_{i,q} - Consensus^{g}_{i,q})/p_{i,q}$, in percent of price, where $Consensus^{g}_{i,q}$ is g's end-of-quarter consensus EPS for quarter q, $Actual^{g}_{i,q}$ its own street actual EPS for the same quarter, and $p_{i,q}$ the closing share price two trading days before the announcement.	I/B/E/S; FactSet; Bloomberg; S&P CapIQ; Zacks; CRSP
$SUE^{Acc}_{i,q}$	Accuracy-weighted SUE, $\sum_g w^{g}_{i,q} SUE^{g}_{i,q}$, with the weights $w^{g}_{i,q}$ of Panel C.	Calculated
$SUE^{X}_{i,q}$	For the benchmark X, equal weighting of the five providers (*EW5*) or I/B/E/S (*IBES*), the benchmark surprise, $SUE^{EW5}_{i,q} = (1/5)\sum_g SUE^{g}_{i,q}$ or I/B/E/S's own $SUE^{g}_{i,q}$.	Calculated
Standardized Pred. Surp.$^{X}_{i,q}$	Min-max standardized predicted surprise $(Consensus^{Acc}_{i,q} - Consensus^{X}_{i,q})/p_{i,q}$, where $Consensus^{Acc}_{i,q} = \sum_g w^{g}_{i,q} Consensus^{g}_{i,q}$ and $Consensus^{X}_{i,q}$ is the benchmark's consensus, the equal-weighted five-FDP consensus or I/B/E/S's own.	Calculated
Panel B. Firm and event controls		
Log Market Equity$_{i,q}$	Natural log of firm i's market capitalization, in millions of dollars, two trading days before the announcement.	CRSP
Book-to-Market$_{i,q}$	Book value of equity for the fiscal quarter that ends in calendar quarter q, divided by market capitalization two trading days before the announcement.	Compustat; CRSP
Leverage$_{i,q}$	Long-term debt plus debt in current liabilities, scaled by total assets, for the fiscal quarter that ends in calendar quarter q.	Compustat
Prior 12-Month Return$_{i,q}$	Buy-and-hold raw return over the twelve months ending one month before firm i's quarter-q announcement.	CRSP
Log Price$_{i,q}$	Natural log of share price two trading days before the announcement.	CRSP
Return Volatility$_{i,q}$	Standard deviation of daily returns over the 60 trading days before the announcement.	CRSP
Analyst Dispersion$_{i,q}$	Standard deviation of analyst EPS forecasts in the I/B/E/S summary file, divided by the share price two trading days before the announcement.	I/B/E/S; CRSP
Busyness$_{i,q}$	Natural log of the number of S&P 1500 firms announcing earnings on firm i's announcement day.	I/B/E/S; Compustat

(continued on next page)

Variable	Definition	Source
$\lvert\Delta IB\rvert_{i,q}$	Absolute change in income before extraordinary items from the previous fiscal quarter, for the fiscal quarter that ends in calendar quarter q, scaled by market capitalization two trading days before the announcement.	Compustat; CRSP
$\lvert\Delta Shares\rvert_{i,q}$	Absolute change in shares outstanding from the previous fiscal quarter, scaled by the previous quarter's shares outstanding, for the fiscal quarter that ends in calendar quarter q.	Compustat
$\lvert SpecItems\rvert_{i,q}$	Absolute value of special items for the fiscal quarter that ends in calendar quarter q, scaled by market capitalization two trading days before the announcement.	Compustat; CRSP
$SBC\ High_{i,q}$	Indicator equal to one if stock-based compensation expense for calendar quarter q, scaled by market capitalization two trading days before the announcement, exceeds the sample median. The expense is the quarterly figure when reported and one quarter of the annual figure otherwise. A missing expense takes the firm's last reported value, or its first later value when none precedes it.	Compustat; CRSP
$Unexpected\ Item_{i,q}$	Indicator equal to one if Compustat special items for the fiscal quarter that ends in calendar quarter q are nonzero.	Compustat
$Stock\ Split_{i,q}$	Indicator equal to one if a stock split's ex-date falls in calendar quarter q.	CRSP
$Fiscal\ Q4_{i,q}$	Indicator equal to one if the fiscal quarter that ends in calendar quarter q is the firm's fourth fiscal quarter.	Compustat
$Institutional\ Ownership_{i,q}$	Shares held by 13F institutions at the end of calendar quarter q, divided by shares outstanding at the end of that quarter and capped at one. The last available value carries forward within the firm.	Thomson Reuters 13F (WRDS); CRSP
$\#\ Analysts_{i,q}$	Number of EPS estimates in the I/B/E/S summary consensus for quarter q at the last statistical period on or before the announcement. It enters the regressions as the log of one plus the count.	I/B/E/S
Panel C. Cross-sectional partitioning and identification variables		
$LLM\ Visibility_i$	Number of source citations, repeats included, in the response of ChatGPT (GPT-4o with web search) to a query for firm i's next-quarter consensus EPS, averaged over three queries issued on May 28 and June 1, 2026.	DataForSEO
$Cross\text{-}FDP\ SUE\ Dispersion_{i,q}$	Interquartile range of $SUE^{g}_{i,q}$ across the five FDPs in firm-quarter (i,q).	Calculated
$IBES\,Up_i$, $IBES\,Down_i$	Indicators equal to one if I/B/E/S's rounded average per-firm-quarter accuracy rank among the five FDPs rises (falls) by at least two positions from pre- to post-ChatGPT.	Calculated
$Outage_{i,q}$	Indicator equal to one if a ChatGPT incident of at least 240 minutes occurs on the calendar day immediately preceding firm i's quarter-q announcement date.	OpenAI
$Large\ Unexpected\ Item\ (LUI_{i,q})$	Indicator equal to one if firm-quarter (i,q) contains a large unexpected item: any of seven Compustat nonrecurring items mapped per Bochkay et al. (2022), with restructuring, acquisition, and special items requiring top-decile magnitude.	Compustat

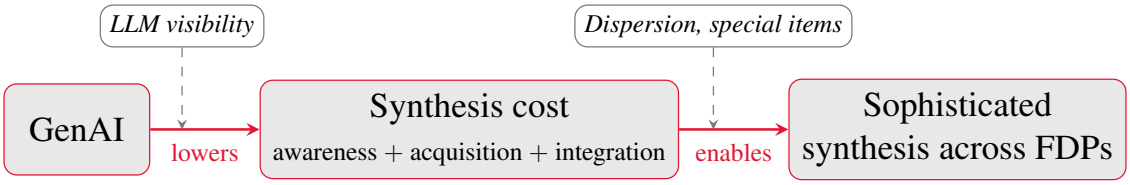
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Variable	Definition	Source
$Post_q$, $Post_q^{Scr}$, regimes R0–R3	Announcement-date indicators: $Post_q = 1$ on or after 2022-11-30 (ChatGPT's public release); $Post_q^{Scr} = 1$ on or after 2023-09-27 (the onset of GPT browsing). The GPT-capability regimes partition the same dates: R0, Pre-ChatGPT (before 2022-11-30); R1, Text-only (to 2023-09-26); R2, Browsing (to 2024-10-30); R3, Native search (2024-10-31 to 2025-12-31, the sample end).	OpenAI
$MAFE_{i,q}^{g}$	Provider g's trailing mean absolute forecast error, $(1/4)\sum_{k=1}^{4} \lvert Actual_{i,q-k}^{g} - Consensus_{i,q-k}^{g} \rvert / p_{i,q-k}$, over the four quarters preceding the announcement.	Calculated
$w_{i,q}^{g}$	Accuracy weight on provider g: the softmax of the within-firm-quarter z-score of $-MAFE_{i,q}^{g}$ across the five FDPs (Section 3.5); uniform when the five accuracies coincide.	Calculated
$Rank_{i,q}^{g}$	Provider g's within-firm-quarter accuracy rank by $MAFE_{i,q}^{g}$ (1 = least accurate, 5 = most accurate).	Calculated
Predictive Value$_{i,q}^{IBES}$	One minus the ratio of the summed absolute residuals of the backward regression of Equation (6), the year-ahead I/B/E/S street actual regressed on the I/B/E/S consensus over up to the twenty most recent source quarters, to the summed absolute year-ahead actuals over the same quarters, winsorized at the 1st and 99th percentiles, as in Equation (7); defined for 22,364 firm-quarters.	I/B/E/S
High $c_{i,q}$, *High* c_i	For a characteristic c, an indicator equal to one when c exceeds its median, with ties assigned to Low. For the firm-quarter characteristics *Cross-FDP SUE Dispersion* and $\lvert$*SpecItems*$\rvert$ (*High Special Items*), the median is taken across firm-quarters (i,q). For the firm characteristics, it is taken across firms (i): *LLM Visibility* (*High Visibility*); in Table 10, firm size (*Log Market Equity*), analyst coverage (*# Analysts*), and *Institutional Ownership*; and in Section 7.6, *Retail Share of Trading* and the firm's mean *Institutional Ownership* and mean *# Analysts* over its announcements before November 30, 2022, firms without such an announcement left unclassified.	Calculated
Retail Share of Trading$_i$	Retail dollar volume (buys plus sells) divided by total dollar volume, each summed over firm i's trading days from January 4, 2021 to November 29, 2022, before ChatGPT's release. Retail trades are those that the WRDS TAQ intraday indicators classify as retail by the sub-penny rule of Boehmer et al. (2021).	WRDS TAQ Intraday Indicators; CRSP
Street-Actual Disagreement$_{i,q}^{gh}$	For a pair of providers g and h, an indicator equal to one if their street actuals for firm-quarter (i,q) are not identical (Table OA3, Panels A and B).	FactSet; Bloomberg; Zacks; S&P Capital IQ; I/B/E/S
Panel D. Analyst revision-level variables (Section 4.2)		
Herding$_{a,i,q,t}$	Indicator equal to one when the revised forecast lands between the analyst's own prior forecast and the prevailing I/B/E/S consensus, and zero otherwise.	I/B/E/S
Prevailing I/B/E/S Consensus$_{i,q,t}$	Mean estimate from the latest I/B/E/S statistical-period summary strictly preceding the revision date, at most 45 days old and based on at least three estimates.	I/B/E/S

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Variable	Definition	Source
Consensus Distance$_{a,i,q,t}$	Absolute distance between the analyst's prior forecast and the prevailing consensus, scaled by the closing share price on the last trading day before the announcement, in percent; enters the regressions as twenty ventile fixed effects.	I/B/E/S; CRSP
General (Firm) Experience$_{a,t}$	Number of years since the analyst's first I/B/E/S forecast (first forecast for firm i).	I/B/E/S
Firms (Industries) Covered$_{a,t}$	Number of distinct firms (two-digit SIC industries) for which the analyst issues forecasts in the revision year.	I/B/E/S; CRSP
Brokerage Size$_{a,t}$	Number of analysts issuing forecasts at the analyst's brokerage in the revision year.	I/B/E/S
Forecast Horizon$_{a,i,q,t}$	Number of days from the revision date to the earnings announcement. Experience, coverage, brokerage size, and horizon enter the regressions as the log of one plus the variable.	I/B/E/S
Panel E. Trading outcomes around earnings announcements (Section 7.6)		
Retail (Large-Trade) Order Imbalance$_{i,q}$	Dollar buy volume minus dollar sell volume of retail trades (of trades of at least \$50,000), divided by their sum, over trading days $[-1,1]$ around firm i's quarter-q announcement, times 100. Retail trades are classified as for *Retail Share of Trading* (Panel C), and the indicators sign trades with the algorithm of Lee and Ready (1991). The second measures take retail trades from the author's TAQ extraction and large trades from \$20,000.	WRDS TAQ Intraday Indicators; TAQ
Abnormal Retail (Large-Trade) Volume$_{i,q}$	Natural log of average daily dollar volume of retail trades (of trades of at least \$50,000) over $[-1,1]$ minus the natural log of its average over $[-60,-11]$, retail volume (buys plus sells) from the author's TAQ extraction.	TAQ; WRDS TAQ Intraday Indicators
Accuracy Tilt$^{X}_{i,q}$	Absolute difference between the benchmark surprise and the accuracy-weighted surprise, $\lvert SUE^{X}_{i,q} - SUE^{Acc}_{i,q}\rvert$, in percent of price; the regressor of the spread test of Section 7.6.	Calculated
Abnormal Quoted (Effective) Spread$_{i,q}$	Natural log of firm i's mean daily percent quoted (effective) spread over the pre-announcement window $[-10,-2]$ minus the natural log of its mean over $[-60,-11]$, in trading days relative to the quarter-q announcement. The quoted spread is the time-weighted mean of the national best ask minus the national best bid, divided by their midpoint, and the effective spread the dollar-weighted mean of twice the absolute difference between the trade price and the prevailing quote midpoint, divided by that midpoint.	WRDS TAQ Intraday Indicators
Active-Fund Ownership Change$_{i,q}$	Sum, over the active domestic-equity mutual-fund portfolios that report at both dates, of the change in the portfolio's holding of firm i, as a percent of shares outstanding, from the last report date before the announcement to the first on or after it. Active portfolios are CRSP domestic-equity portfolios that are neither index funds nor ETFs. The report dates are quarter-ends in the quarterly window and month-ends of monthly reporters in the monthly window.	CRSP Mutual Fund Holdings; CRSP
Active-Fund Breadth$_{i,q}$	Among the same portfolios, the number that raise their holding of firm i minus the number that cut it, divided by the number that hold the firm at the start of the window.	CRSP Mutual Fund Holdings

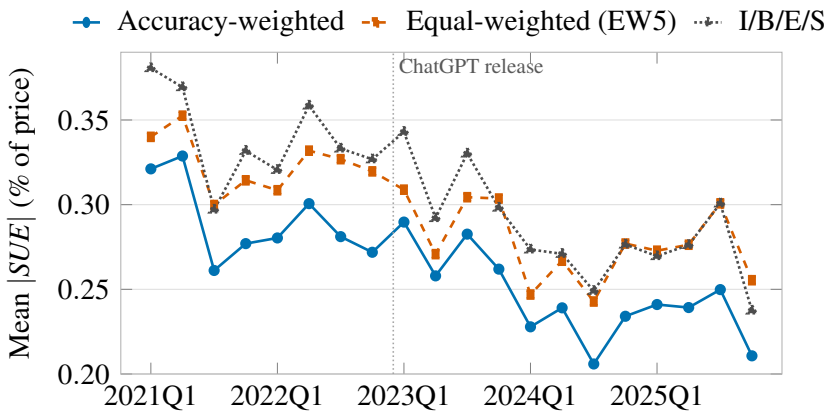
FIGURE 1. Theoretical Framework



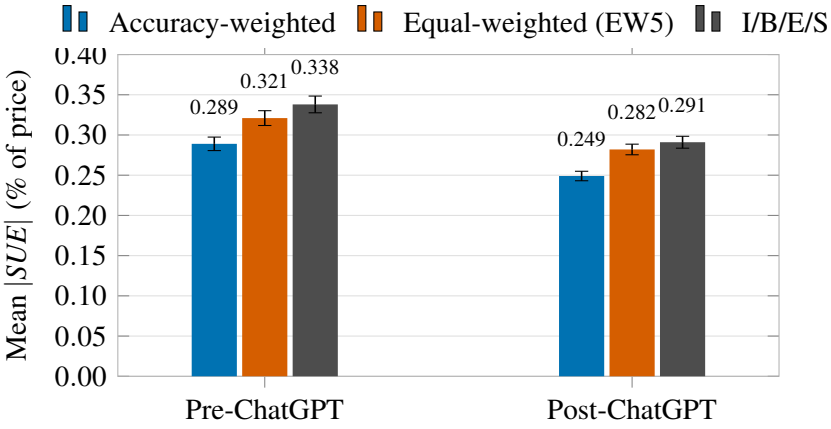
Notes. This figure summarizes the theoretical framework. Generative AI (GenAI) lowers the cost of synthesizing analyst consensus forecasts across the five forecast data providers (FDPs), the joint cost of *awareness*, *acquisition*, and *integration* in the Blankespoor et al. (2020) decomposition, which in turn enables the market to price a sophisticated, accuracy-weighted synthesis across providers in place of a single-FDP or equal-weighted benchmark. The strength of the channel is moderated by how *accessible* synthesis is for a given firm (LLM visibility, the information-acquisition channel) and by how *valuable* it is (cross-FDP disagreement and special-items magnitude). These mechanisms map to Predictions 1 and 2, developed in Section 2. Prediction 1's quality dimension covers both trailing accuracy and the consensus's predictive value for the firm's future results.

FIGURE 2. Mean Magnitude of *SUE*: Accuracy-Weighted vs. the Two Benchmarks

(a) Quarterly mean $|SUE|$ by consensus method



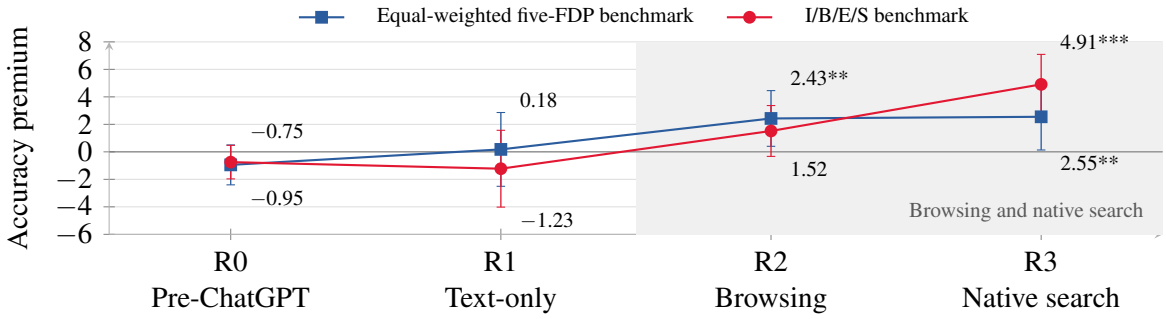
(b) Mean $|SUE|$ by consensus method



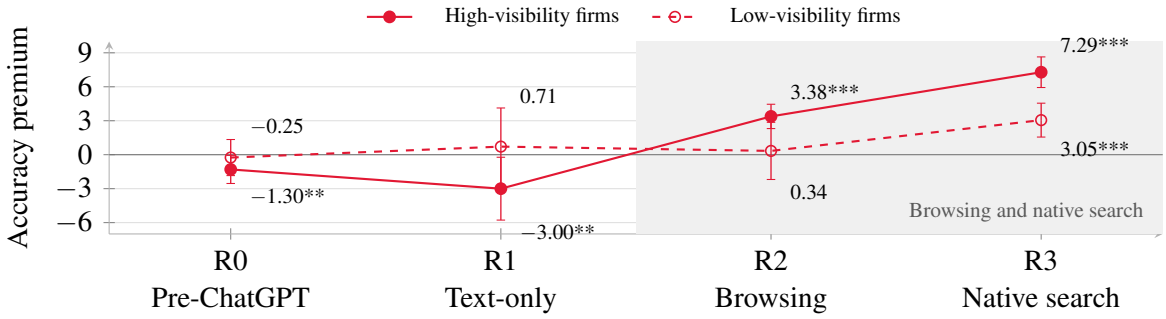
Notes. This figure compares the accuracy of the accuracy-weighted multi-vendor consensus SUE^{Acc} against the equal-weighted five-FDP consensus SUE^{EW5} and the I/B/E/S consensus SUE^{IBES} across the five-FDP sample (FactSet, Bloomberg, Zacks, Capital IQ, I/B/E/S) of S&P 1500 firm-quarters with announcement dates in 2021Q1–2025Q4. $|SUE|$ is the absolute standardized unexpected earnings, scaled by the closing share price two trading days before the announcement and expressed in percent, winsorized at the 1st and 99th percentiles. **Panel (a)** plots the quarterly mean $|SUE|$ for each of the three methods over 20 announcement quarters. The vertical reference line marks the public release of ChatGPT (November 30, 2022). **Panel (b)** shows the pooled mean $|SUE|$ within each of the pre- and post-ChatGPT periods, with 95% confidence intervals from the cell-level standard error of the mean. The y-axis starts at zero so that bar height is proportional to the mean.

FIGURE 3. The Accuracy Premium Across GPT-Capability Regimes, All Firms and by LLM Visibility

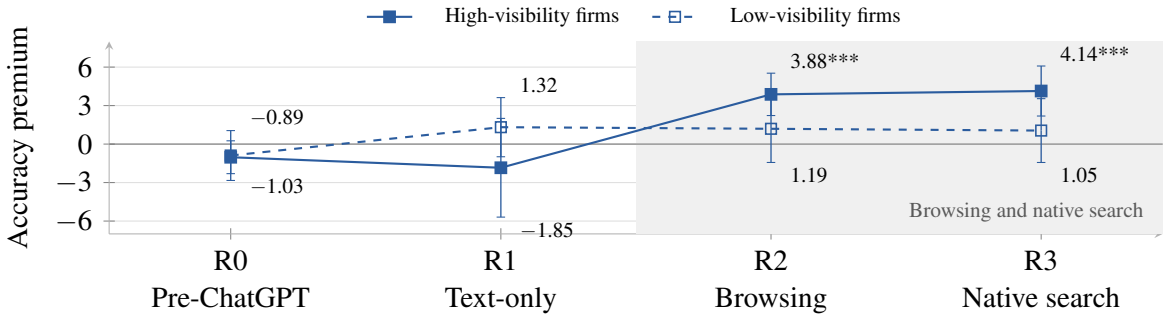
(a) All firms, by benchmark



(b) High- against low-visibility firms, I/B/E/S benchmark

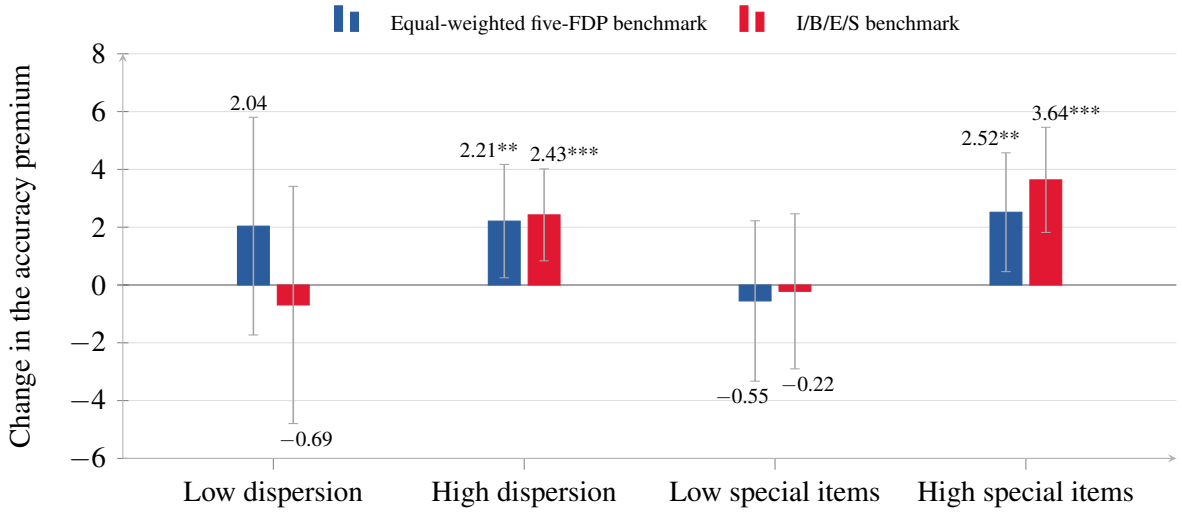


(c) High- against low-visibility firms, equal-weighted five-FDP benchmark



Notes. This figure plots the accuracy premium, the contrast $\beta_1 - \beta_2$ between the loading of the three-day market-adjusted $CAR_{[-1,1]}$ (in percent) on the accuracy-weighted surprise SUE^{Acc} and its loading on the benchmark surprise (both in percent of price), estimated separately within each GPT-capability regime (R0 to R3, defined in Appendix A). Panel (a) plots the estimates of Table 8 for all firms, against the I/B/E/S benchmark (red circles) and the equal-weighted five-FDP benchmark (blue squares). Panels (b) and (c) plot the estimates of Table 11 for high-visibility firms (solid lines, filled markers) and low-visibility firms (dashed lines, open markers), against the I/B/E/S benchmark in Panel (b) and the equal-weighted five-FDP benchmark in Panel (c). In Panels (b) and (c) the vertical distance between the two lines is the difference-in-differences contrast $\beta_3 - \beta_4$ of Table 11. The shaded band marks the regimes in which the model can retrieve forecasts from the web. Whiskers are 95 percent confidence intervals computed from the t-statistics of the two tables (firm-clustered in Table 8, two-way clustered by firm and calendar year in Table 11), and each label reports the estimate with its significance ($^{*}p < 0.10$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$).

FIGURE 4. The Change in the Accuracy Premium by Cross-FDP Dispersion and by Special Items



Notes. This figure plots the post-scraping change in the accuracy premium, $\beta_3 - \beta_4$ of Equation (10) with the post-scraping indicator in place of $Post_q$, estimated within the below- and above-median halves of the two partitions of Table 9: Panel A on concurrent cross-FDP SUE dispersion (the first two groups) and Panel B on special-items magnitude (the last two). The blue bars use the equal-weighted five-FDP benchmark and the red bars the I/B/E/S benchmark. The bar labels report the change, in percentage points of announcement return per percentage point of surprise, with its significance ($^{*}p < 0.10$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$), and the whiskers are 95 percent confidence intervals computed from the firm-clustered t-statistics of Table 9.

TABLE 1. Sample Selection

Sample construction (firm × quarter)	**Observations**	**# Firms**
S&P 1500 firm-quarters with an earnings announcement (announcement date 2021–2025)	29,395	1,502
Retain firm-quarters with non-missing consensus from all five FDPs (FactSet, Bloomberg, Zacks, Capital IQ, and I/B/E/S)	25,027	1,353
Drop firm-quarters missing market-outcome variables or required controls	(1,179)	(13)
Drop firm-quarters missing any constructed return or predicted-surprise variable	(10)	(1)
Drop firms with only one firm-quarter (no within-firm variation for firm fixed effects)	(5)	(5)
Final Sample	**23,833**	**1,334**

Notes. This table reports the sample selection procedure for the firm-quarter sample. Counts in parentheses are the firm-quarters (firms) dropped at that step. All other rows report the number surviving. The sample is used in the main across-FDP tests and is built from CRSP, Compustat, I/B/E/S, and the five-FDP consensus panel.

TABLE 2. Descriptive Statistics

	N	Mean	SD	Min	p25	Median	p75	Max
1. Dependent Variables: Abnormal Returns (%)								
$CAR^{Mkt}_{[-1,1]}$	23,833	0.204	7.739	-22.532	-3.933	0.168	4.255	23.535
$CAR^{FFC}_{[-1,1]}$	23,833	0.196	7.635	-22.779	-3.776	0.186	4.135	23.606
$BHAR^{Mkt}_{[-2,1]}$	23,833	0.228	7.978	-22.803	-4.165	0.177	4.418	24.992
$BHAR^{FFC}_{[-2,1]}$	23,833	0.193	7.847	-22.935	-3.966	0.111	4.255	24.819
2. Per-FDP Standardized Earnings Surprise (SUE^g, %)								
$SUE^{FactSet}$	23,833	0.132	0.534	-2.190	0.000	0.074	0.238	2.484
$SUE^{Bloomberg}$	23,833	-0.222	1.659	-10.049	-0.362	-0.027	0.162	5.780
SUE^{Zacks}	23,833	0.149	0.467	-1.606	0.000	0.075	0.240	2.291
SUE^{CapIQ}	23,833	0.137	0.530	-2.185	0.001	0.076	0.243	2.477
SUE^{IBES}	23,833	0.130	0.548	-2.271	0.000	0.075	0.241	2.502
3. Cross-FDP Composites and Predicted Surprise								
SUE^{Acc}	23,833	0.110	0.450	-1.656	-0.015	0.059	0.212	1.972
SUE^{EW5}	23,833	0.066	0.510	-1.936	-0.064	0.041	0.201	1.942
SUE^{Acc4}	23,832	0.134	0.429	-1.448	0.001	0.073	0.231	1.960
SUE^{EW4}	23,833	0.137	0.441	-1.461	0.001	0.076	0.239	1.948
$Standardized\ Pred.Surp.^{EW5}$	23,833	0.606	0.116	0.000	0.590	0.619	0.631	1.000
$Standardized\ Pred.Surp.^{IBES}$	23,833	0.483	0.109	0.000	0.469	0.478	0.493	1.000
4. Firm and Event Controls								
Log Market Equity	23,833	8.992	1.448	6.390	7.923	8.769	9.942	12.883
Book-to-Market	23,833	0.440	0.361	-0.159	0.170	0.362	0.634	1.670
Leverage	23,833	0.314	0.218	0.001	0.133	0.301	0.444	1.008
Prior 12-Month Return	23,833	0.201	0.487	-0.589	-0.101	0.112	0.379	2.400
Log Price	23,833	4.166	0.980	1.880	3.491	4.178	4.831	6.580
Return Volatility	23,833	0.021	0.009	0.009	0.015	0.019	0.025	0.054
Analyst Dispersion	23,833	0.002	0.003	0.000	0.000	0.001	0.002	0.018
Busyness	23,833	4.944	0.973	1.946	4.431	5.124	5.684	6.299
$\lvert\Delta$ *Income Before Extraordinary Items*$\rvert$	23,833	0.012	0.026	0.000	0.001	0.004	0.011	0.178
$\lvert\Delta$ *Shares Outstanding*$\rvert$	23,833	0.010	0.021	0.000	0.001	0.003	0.009	0.150
$\lvert$*Special Items*$\rvert$	23,833	0.003	0.010	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.002	0.074
High Stock-Based Compensation	23,833	0.500	0.500	0.000	0.000	0.000	1.000	1.000
Unexpected Item	23,833	0.686	0.464	0.000	0.000	1.000	1.000	1.000
Stock Split	23,833	0.003	0.051	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.000	1.000
Fiscal Q4	23,833	0.250	0.433	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.000	1.000
Institutional Ownership	23,833	0.850	0.238	0.011	0.813	0.940	1.000	1.000
# Analysts	23,833	10.914	6.536	2.000	6.000	10.000	15.000	31.000
5. Identification, Weighting, and Partitioning Variables								
$Predictive\ Value^{IBES}$	22,364	0.666	0.252	-0.036	0.558	0.756	0.851	0.947
$Rank^g$	119,165	3.000	1.414	1.000	2.000	3.000	4.000	5.000

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	N	Mean	SD	Min	p25	Median	p75	Max
Cross-FDP SUE Dispersion	23,833	0.108	0.261	0.000	0.007	0.024	0.081	1.804
Log # Analysts	23,833	2.322	0.573	1.099	1.946	2.398	2.773	3.466
LLM Visibility	23,827	13.257	2.985	7.667	11.000	13.000	15.000	21.333
Post-ChatGPT	23,833	0.604	0.489	0.000	0.000	1.000	1.000	1.000
Post-Scraping ($Post^{Scr}$)	23,833	0.448	0.497	0.000	0.000	0.000	1.000	1.000
Regime 1 (Text-only)	23,833	0.157	0.364	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.000	1.000
Regime 2 (Browsing)	23,833	0.233	0.423	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.000	1.000
Regime 3 (Native search)	23,833	0.215	0.411	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.000	1.000
6. Cross-Sectional Partitioning Indicators								
High Visibility	23,827	0.489	0.500	0.000	0.000	0.000	1.000	1.000
High Cross-FDP Dispersion	23,833	0.500	0.500	0.000	0.000	0.000	1.000	1.000
High Special Items	23,833	0.500	0.500	0.000	0.000	0.000	1.000	1.000
High Firm Size	23,044	0.516	0.500	0.000	0.000	1.000	1.000	1.000
High Analyst Coverage (Table 10)	23,044	0.515	0.500	0.000	0.000	1.000	1.000	1.000
High Inst. Ownership (Table 10)	23,044	0.503	0.500	0.000	0.000	1.000	1.000	1.000
IBES Accuracy-Rank Up	23,833	0.099	0.299	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.000	1.000
IBES Accuracy-Rank Down	23,833	0.059	0.236	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.000	1.000
ChatGPT Outage (prior day)	23,833	0.004	0.059	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.000	1.000
7. Analyst Revision Panel (Section 4.2)								
Herding	122,001	0.323	0.468	0.000	0.000	0.000	1.000	1.000
Consensus Distance (% of price)	122,001	0.227	0.379	0.004	0.031	0.084	0.238	2.321
General Experience (years)	122,001	16.025	11.341	0.416	6.940	13.317	22.563	41.462
Firm Experience (years)	122,001	7.281	6.822	0.079	1.996	5.183	10.691	33.435
# Firms Covered	122,001	23.255	8.999	4.000	17.000	22.000	28.000	51.000
# Industries Covered	122,001	9.357	4.455	2.000	6.000	9.000	12.000	21.000
Brokerage Size	122,001	81.793	65.585	2.000	31.000	65.000	114.000	251.000
Forecast Horizon (days)	122,001	69.957	38.847	2.000	29.000	85.000	91.000	162.000
8. Additional Tests (Section 7)								
SUE^{Est}	13,830	0.072	0.425	-1.659	-0.033	0.030	0.152	1.975
Retail Share of Trading	23,708	0.051	0.027	0.021	0.035	0.043	0.059	0.174
High Retail Share of Trading	23,476	0.497	0.500	0.000	0.000	0.000	1.000	1.000
High Inst. Ownership (pre-ChatGPT)	23,515	0.499	0.500	0.000	0.000	0.000	1.000	1.000
High # Analysts (pre-ChatGPT)	23,515	0.510	0.500	0.000	0.000	1.000	1.000	1.000
$Accuracy\ Tilt^{EW5}$	23,833	0.140	0.239	0.000	0.015	0.051	0.149	1.422
$Accuracy\ Tilt^{IBES}$	23,833	0.131	0.266	0.000	0.009	0.031	0.114	1.621
Abnormal Quoted Spread	23,221	-0.051	0.238	-0.785	-0.180	-0.032	0.090	0.612
Abnormal Effective Spread	23,221	-0.051	0.237	-0.658	-0.197	-0.057	0.086	0.666

Notes. This table reports descriptive statistics for the across-FDP sample of S&P 1500 firm-quarters with announcement dates in 2021–2025 used in the main tests. All continuous variables are winsorized at the 1st and 99th percentiles. *LLM Visibility* and *High Visibility* are defined for 23,827 of the 23,833 firm-quarters. *# Analysts* enters the regressions as *Log # Analysts*, the log of one plus the count. $Rank^g$ is summarized over the provider-firm-quarters of Table 3, Panel A, and the high-group indicators of Table 10 over its sample. $MAFE^g$ and the softmax weights w^g are construction inputs to SUE^{Acc} (Section 3.5). Category 8 reports each variable on the firm-quarters for which it is defined. Variable definitions are in Appendix A, and those of SUE^{Acc4}, SUE^{EW4}, and SUE^{Est} in the notes to Table 12.

TABLE 3. Earnings Response Coefficients by Provider Accuracy Rank and by Change in I/B/E/S's Accuracy Rank

Panel A. Earnings-response coefficients by forecast-provider accuracy rank

	Pre-ChatGPT		Post-ChatGPT	
Provider	β	γ	β	γ
I/B/E/S	2.591***	0.022	2.611***	0.295**
	(6.60)	(0.17)	(5.49)	(2.09)
FactSet	2.316***	0.050	2.059***	0.380**
	(4.78)	(0.36)	(3.80)	(2.42)
Bloomberg	0.985***	-0.058	0.789***	0.162**
	(5.82)	(-0.80)	(5.01)	(2.10)
Zacks	3.603***	-0.139	4.757***	-0.020
	(8.35)	(-1.04)	(8.57)	(-0.13)
Capital IQ	1.107**	0.543***	2.483***	0.349**
	(2.40)	(3.94)	(4.94)	(2.40)
Stacked	**1.206*** **	**0.306*** **	**0.973*** **	**0.621*** **
	(9.21)	**(6.93)**	**(8.09)**	**(11.65)**
Observations	47,130		72,035	
Stacked Δ (Post−Pre)			**-0.232**	**0.316*** **
			(-1.38)	**(4.91)**

Panel B. Heterogeneous post-ChatGPT effects by firm-level I/B/E/S accuracy-rank change

Dep. Var.:	Market-adjusted $CAR_{[-1,1]}$		FFC $CAR_{[-1,1]}$	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
SUE^{IBES}	2.859***	2.845***	2.775***	2.776***
	(13.91)	(14.03)	(13.67)	(13.84)
$SUE^{IBES} \times Post$	1.029***	0.978***	1.136***	1.065***
	(3.56)	(3.32)	(4.11)	(3.76)
$SUE^{IBES} \times IBES\,Up$	0.693	0.628	0.803	0.737
	(1.24)	(1.16)	(1.46)	(1.39)
$SUE^{IBES} \times IBES\,Down$	1.397*	1.582**	1.913***	2.080***
	(1.81)	(2.00)	(2.61)	(2.74)
$\boldsymbol{SUE^{IBES} \times Post \times IBES\,Up}$	**-1.248**	**-1.135**	**-1.291**	**-1.185**
	(-1.44)	**(-1.30)**	**(-1.40)**	**(-1.26)**
$\boldsymbol{SUE^{IBES} \times Post \times IBES\,Down}$	**-2.278*** **	**-2.344*** **	**-2.758*** **	**-2.791*** **
	(-2.27)	**(-2.15)**	**(-2.70)**	**(-2.51)**
$Post \times IBES\,Up$	0.353	0.232	0.437	0.297
	(1.13)	(0.68)	(1.37)	(0.85)
$Post \times IBES\,Down$	0.544	0.713	0.678*	0.859*
	(1.34)	(1.61)	(1.68)	(1.95)
Controls	No	Yes	No	Yes
Firm FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Observations	23,833	23,833	23,833	23,833
Adjusted R^2	0.052	0.070	0.054	0.072

Notes. Both panels test whether the market relies more on more accurate forecasts. **Panel A** estimates Equation (4) without controls or fixed effects (FE), so that γ is the ERC increment per one-rank accuracy improvement. Each provider row is a separate regression, the *Stacked* row pools all five FDPs' surprises across firm-quarters, and the *Stacked* Δ row reports the $SUE \times Post$ and $SUE \times Rank \times Post$ coefficients from the pooled regression that interacts every term with *Post*. **Panel B** estimates Equation (5) at the firm-quarter level. The bolded triple interactions are the key coefficients, the remaining lower-order terms are included but not reported, and the specification includes the firm and event controls and firm and year fixed effects. Standard errors are clustered by firm. Continuous variables are winsorized at the 1st and 99th percentiles. t-statistics in parentheses; $^{*}p < 0.10$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$. Variable definitions are in Appendix A.

TABLE 4. Analyst Herding Toward the I/B/E/S Consensus and the Accuracy-Rank Partition

	Single post-ChatGPT indicator		GPT-capability regimes	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Post	0.044**	0.049**		
	(2.01)	(2.23)		
Post × *IBES Up* (β_1)	0.012	0.016		
	(0.71)	(0.90)		
Post × *IBES Down* (β_2)	-0.048***	-0.056***		
	(-2.62)	(-2.63)		
R1 (Text-only) × *IBES Up* ($\beta_{1,1}$)			0.002	0.006
			(0.11)	(0.30)
R1 (Text-only) × *IBES Down* ($\beta_{2,1}$)			-0.049**	-0.053**
			(-2.07)	(-1.98)
R2 (Browsing) × *IBES Up* ($\beta_{1,2}$)			0.016	0.021
			(0.84)	(1.09)
R2 (Browsing) × *IBES Down* ($\beta_{2,2}$)			-0.059**	-0.065**
			(-2.45)	(-2.41)
R3 (Native search) × *IBES Up* ($\beta_{1,3}$)			0.019	0.023
			(0.83)	(0.96)
R3 (Native search) × *IBES Down* ($\beta_{2,3}$)			-0.034	-0.049**
			(-1.59)	(-2.19)
Spread ($\beta_1 - \beta_2$)	**0.060****	**0.072*****		
	(2.54)	**(2.79)**		
Spread, R1 ($\beta_{1,1} - \beta_{2,1}$)			**0.052***	**0.059***
			(1.78)	**(1.88)**
Spread, R2 ($\beta_{1,2} - \beta_{2,2}$)			**0.075****	**0.086*****
			(2.57)	**(2.75)**
Spread, R3 ($\beta_{1,3} - \beta_{2,3}$)			**0.052***	**0.072****
			(1.79)	**(2.32)**
Lower-order terms	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Firm and event controls	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Analyst controls	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Analyst FE	Yes	No	Yes	No
Firm FE	Yes	No	Yes	No
Analyst×Firm FE	No	Yes	No	Yes
Revision-year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Distance-ventile FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Observations	122,001	120,868	122,001	120,868
Adjusted R^2	0.107	0.107	0.107	0.107

Notes. This table tests whether analysts' herding toward the prevailing I/B/E/S consensus falls after ChatGPT in the firms where I/B/E/S loses accuracy rank. The sample comprises 122,001 quarterly EPS forecast revisions over 2019–2025. The dependent variable is *Herding* (base rate 0.32). *IBES Up*$_i$ and *IBES Down*$_i$ are the accuracy-rank-change indicators of Table 3, interacted with the single *Post* indicator in columns (1)–(2) and with the GPT-capability regimes in columns (3)–(4). The bolded *Spread* rows report $\beta_1 - \beta_2$ and $\beta_{1,r} - \beta_{2,r}$. All columns include the lower-order terms, the firm and event controls of Equation (5), the Clement (1999) analyst controls, and distance-ventile fixed effects (FE). Columns (1)/(3) add analyst, firm, and revision-year fixed effects, columns (2)/(4) analyst×firm pair and revision-year fixed effects. t-statistics in parentheses; standard errors cluster by firm; $^{*}p < 0.10$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$. Variable definitions are in Appendix A.

TABLE 5. The Predictive Value of the I/B/E/S Consensus: Measurement and Post-ChatGPT Pricing

Dep. Var.:	Single post-ChatGPT indicator		GPT-capability regimes	
	Mkt CAR	FFC CAR	Mkt CAR	FFC CAR
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
SUE^{IBES} (β_1)	1.768***	1.766***	1.765***	1.765***
	(5.77)	(5.87)	(5.79)	(5.89)
$SUE^{IBES} \times Post$ (β_2)	-0.194	-0.151		
	(-0.46)	(-0.35)		
$SUE^{IBES}\times$ Regime 1 (Text-only)			0.395	0.580
			(0.76)	(1.09)
$SUE^{IBES}\times$ Regime 2 (Browsing)			0.151	-0.118
			(0.25)	(-0.18)
$SUE^{IBES}\times$ Regime 3 (Native search)			-0.936	-0.755
			(-1.39)	(-1.15)
$SUE^{IBES} \times Predictive\ Value^{IBES}$ (β_3)	2.764***	2.736***	2.773***	2.745***
	(4.70)	(4.78)	(4.72)	(4.81)
$SUE^{IBES} \times Predictive\ Value^{IBES} \times Post$ (β_4)	**3.110*** **	**3.123*** **		
	(3.53)	**(3.51)**		
$SUE^{IBES} \times Predictive\ Value^{IBES}\times$ Regime 1			**1.653**	**1.589**
			(1.60)	**(1.52)**
$SUE^{IBES} \times Predictive\ Value^{IBES}\times$ Regime 2			**2.454****	**2.882****
			(2.13)	**(2.41)**
$SUE^{IBES} \times Predictive\ Value^{IBES}\times$ Regime 3			**5.101*** **	**4.790*** **
			(3.44)	**(3.26)**
Lower-order terms	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Controls	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Firm FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Observations	22,356	22,356	22,356	22,356
Adjusted R^2	0.084	0.085	0.084	0.086

Notes. This table tests whether the post-ChatGPT strengthening of announcement-window reactions concentrates in firms whose I/B/E/S consensus has closely anticipated the firm's future street numbers. *Predictive Value*^{IBES} is the first-stage score of Equation (7), computed from the backward regression of Equation (6). It covers 22,364 of the 23,833 firm-quarters (8,730 pre-ChatGPT), of which 22,356 enter the regressions. The uncovered firm-quarters are recent listings with fewer than twelve scorable history quarters. Columns (1)–(2) estimate Equation (8) with the three-day market-adjusted and FFC $CAR_{[-1,1]}$ as the dependent variable. β_3 is the pre-ChatGPT gradient of the ERC in predictive value and the bolded β_4 is its post-ChatGPT increment. Columns (3)–(4) replace the single *Post* indicator with the three post-ChatGPT GPT-capability regimes. Because the native-search regime spans only the final five sample quarters, the regime profile is descriptive and the pooled increment in columns (1)–(2) is the formal test. All columns include the lower-order terms, the firm and event controls, and firm and year fixed effects (FE). Standard errors are clustered by firm. t-statistics in parentheses; $^{*}p < 0.10$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$. Variable definitions are in Appendix A.

TABLE 6. Accuracy Persistence and the Predicted-Surprise Trading Strategy

Panel A. Persistence of FDP accuracy ranks (trailing-MAFE rank, quarter t to $t+1$)

	$\Pr(Rank_{t+1} = j \mid Rank_t = i)$				
$Rank_t$	$j=1$ *(least)*	$j=2$	$j=3$	$j=4$	$j=5$ *(most)*
1 *(least)*	0.761	0.121	0.049	0.034	0.036
2	0.121	0.541	0.197	0.089	0.052
3	0.047	0.195	0.467	0.211	0.080
4	0.034	0.091	0.208	0.483	0.185
5 *(most)*	0.038	0.052	0.079	0.184	0.647

Spearman $\rho = 0.71$; overall same-rank rate $= 0.58$; 109,915 quarter-to-quarter pairs.

Panel B. Trading strategy from predicted surprise

Dep. Var.:	Market-adj. $BHAR_{[-2,1]}$		FFC $BHAR_{[-2,1]}$	
Benchmark:	Equal-Weighted	IBES	Equal-Weighted	IBES
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Standardized Pred. Surp.	**2.493*****	**3.433*****	**2.440*****	**3.357*****
	(4.10)	**(5.35)**	**(4.08)**	**(5.25)**
Long−Short Return (Q5−Q1)	**0.73%*****	**1.35%*****	**0.63%*****	**1.35%*****
Controls	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Firm FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Observations (firm-quarters)	23,833	23,833	23,833	23,833
Adjusted R^2	0.016	0.017	0.018	0.019

Notes. This table motivates the accuracy-weighted consensus. **Panel A** reports the quarter-to-quarter persistence of accuracy ranks (ranks by trailing mean absolute forecast error, MAFE): cell (i, j) is the share of provider-quarters at Rank i that move to Rank j the following quarter (rows sum to one up to rounding). **Panel B** tests whether the standardized predicted surprise against each benchmark $X \in \{EW5, IBES\}$ forecasts the four-day announcement-window abnormal return: columns (1)–(2) use the market-adjusted $BHAR_{[-2,1]}$ and columns (3)–(4) the FFC $BHAR_{[-2,1]}$. The Long−Short row reports the abnormal return, in percent per announcement, from going long the top quintile and short the bottom quintile of the predicted surprise over the $[-2, 1]$ window. All Panel B columns include firm and year fixed effects (FE), the firm and event controls, and firm-clustered standard errors. Continuous variables are winsorized at the 1st and 99th percentiles. t-statistics in parentheses; $^{*}p < 0.10$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$. Variable definitions are in Appendix A.

TABLE 7. The Accuracy Premium: Horse Races Between the Accuracy-Weighted and Benchmark Surprises

Panel A. Horse race: SUE^{Acc} vs. SUE^{EW5}

Dep. Var.:	Mkt CAR$_{[-1,1]}$			FFC CAR$_{[-1,1]}$		
	(1) Pre	(2) Post	(3) Pooled	(4) Pre	(5) Post	(6) Pooled
SUE^{Acc} (β_1)	1.376***	3.420***	1.307***	1.401***	3.519***	1.290***
	(3.45)	(9.38)	(3.60)	(3.63)	(10.01)	(3.67)
$SUE^{Acc} \times Post$ (β_3)			2.003***			2.135***
			(4.08)			(4.47)
SUE^{EW5} (β_2)	2.324***	1.767***	2.279***	2.379***	1.734***	2.284***
	(6.10)	(5.56)	(6.84)	(6.44)	(5.62)	(7.03)
$SUE^{EW5} \times Post$ (β_4)			-0.399			-0.449
			(-0.92)			(-1.06)
Premium (Pre-ChatGPT)	-0.948		-0.972	-0.978		-0.994
	(-1.28)		(-1.47)	(-1.37)		(-1.55)
Premium (Post-ChatGPT)		1.654***	1.429**		1.785***	1.590***
		(2.62)	(2.39)		(2.93)	(2.74)
Δ Premium (Post−Pre)			**2.401*** **			**2.584*** **
			(2.75)			**(3.03)**
Control Variables						
Log Market Equity	-5.348***	-4.964***	-2.848***	-5.585***	-5.125***	-3.238***
	(-5.35)	(-5.35)	(-6.00)	(-5.59)	(-5.74)	(-7.19)
Book-to-Market	0.413	-1.315	0.168	0.849	-1.245	0.309
	(0.36)	(-1.22)	(0.28)	(0.75)	(-1.16)	(0.53)
Leverage	-4.957**	-3.652*	-0.913	-4.561**	-4.067**	-1.312
	(-2.38)	(-1.70)	(-0.76)	(-2.17)	(-1.97)	(-1.13)
Prior 12-Month Return	-0.295	-0.868**	-0.235	-0.024	-1.038***	-0.129
	(-1.27)	(-2.52)	(-1.27)	(-0.11)	(-3.02)	(-0.71)
Log Price	-1.063	-1.047	-0.482	-0.671	-0.735	-0.029
	(-1.13)	(-1.12)	(-1.05)	(-0.71)	(-0.83)	(-0.07)
Return Volatility	-59.587***	27.445*	14.899	-53.652***	19.210	11.467
	(-3.08)	(1.66)	(1.34)	(-2.87)	(1.20)	(1.05)
Analyst Dispersion	-23.636	-40.842	-15.946	-11.993	-17.323	-2.625
	(-0.40)	(-0.71)	(-0.40)	(-0.20)	(-0.30)	(-0.07)
Busyness	-0.104	-0.245*	-0.172*	-0.132	-0.219*	-0.164*
	(-0.73)	(-1.83)	(-1.79)	(-0.93)	(-1.66)	(-1.72)
$\lvert\Delta IB\rvert$	16.729***	-4.012	2.450	17.171***	-4.609	2.027
	(2.98)	(-0.78)	(0.69)	(3.09)	(-0.91)	(0.58)
$\lvert\Delta Shares\rvert$	3.721	-1.964	1.505	3.251	-2.171	1.376
	(0.79)	(-0.51)	(0.52)	(0.72)	(-0.57)	(0.48)
$\lvert SpecItems\rvert$	-18.458	-8.991	-10.912	-21.400*	-7.112	-9.847
	(-1.50)	(-0.79)	(-1.33)	(-1.77)	(-0.64)	(-1.22)
SBC High	-0.149	0.174	0.106	-0.168	0.186	0.095
	(-0.57)	(0.77)	(0.65)	(-0.66)	(0.83)	(0.59)
Unexpected Item	-0.258	-0.036	-0.123	-0.222	-0.023	-0.103
	(-0.97)	(-0.17)	(-0.78)	(-0.89)	(-0.11)	(-0.68)
Stock Split	-2.679**	-1.110	-1.584*	-2.266*	-0.472	-0.977
	(-2.21)	(-0.92)	(-1.90)	(-1.78)	(-0.42)	(-1.18)
Fiscal Q4	0.600***	-0.045	0.276**	0.606***	0.230	0.417***
	(2.83)	(-0.24)	(2.07)	(2.89)	(1.23)	(3.19)
Institutional Ownership	3.234	-0.702**	-0.470	1.626	-0.543	-0.416
	(1.56)	(-2.02)	(-1.41)	(0.83)	(-1.57)	(-1.25)

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Table 7 continued from previous page

Log # Analysts	0.508	-0.218	-0.248	0.648	-0.328	-0.371
	(0.79)	(-0.39)	(-0.65)	(1.04)	(-0.60)	(-0.99)
Controls	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Firm FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Observations	9,405	14,402	23,833	9,405	14,402	23,833
Adjusted R^2	0.085	0.106	0.080	0.092	0.110	0.083

Panel B. Horse race: SUE^{Acc} vs. SUE^{IBES}

Dep. Var.:	Mkt CAR$_{[-1,1]}$			FFC CAR$_{[-1,1]}$		
	(1) Pre	(2) Post	(3) Pooled	(4) Pre	(5) Post	(6) Pooled
SUE^{Acc} (β_1)	1.428***	3.678***	1.430***	1.527***	3.796***	1.494***
	(4.00)	(10.49)	(4.31)	(4.36)	(10.70)	(4.48)
$SUE^{Acc} \times Post$ (β_3)			2.153***			2.204***
			(4.82)			(4.98)
SUE^{IBES} (β_2)	2.176***	1.460***	2.054***	2.149***	1.407***	1.974***
	(7.08)	(4.44)	(7.31)	(7.20)	(4.20)	(7.01)
$SUE^{IBES} \times Post$ (β_4)			-0.519			-0.484
			(-1.34)			(-1.28)
Premium (Pre-ChatGPT)	-0.747		-0.623	-0.622		-0.480
	(-1.20)		(-1.09)	(-1.03)		(-0.83)
Premium (Post-ChatGPT)		2.219***	2.049***		2.389***	2.208***
		(3.56)	(3.60)		(3.75)	(3.82)
Δ Premium (Post−Pre)			**2.672*** **			**2.688*** **
			(3.44)			**(3.50)**
Controls	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Firm FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Observations	9,405	14,402	23,833	9,405	14,402	23,833
Adjusted R^2	0.087	0.106	0.080	0.094	0.110	0.083

Notes. This table reports OLS estimates of the horse race of Equation (10) between the accuracy-weighted surprise SUE^{Acc} and a benchmark surprise SUE^{X}, where $Post_q$ is the post-ChatGPT indicator. **Panel A** uses the equal-weighted benchmark SUE^{EW5} and **Panel B** the I/B/E/S benchmark SUE^{IBES}. Both panels use the same firm and event controls, which Panel B suppresses for brevity. Columns (1) and (4) restrict the sample to pre-ChatGPT announcements and columns (2) and (5) to post-ChatGPT announcements, so the *Post* interactions drop out. Columns (3) and (6) pool both periods. Columns (1)–(3) use the market-adjusted $CAR_{[-1,1]}$ and columns (4)–(6) use the Fama–French–Carhart (FFC) four-factor $CAR_{[-1,1]}$. The *Premium* rows (pre-ChatGPT, post-ChatGPT) report the accuracy premium, the loading on SUE^{Acc} minus the loading on the benchmark: $\beta_1 - \beta_2$ in the single-period columns and in the pre-ChatGPT row of the pooled columns, and $(\beta_1 + \beta_3) - (\beta_2 + \beta_4)$ in the post-ChatGPT row of the pooled columns. The bolded Δ Premium row reports the post-minus-pre change, $\beta_3 - \beta_4$. All columns include firm and year fixed effects (FE) and the firm and event controls. Standard errors are clustered by firm. Continuous variables are winsorized at the 1st and 99th percentiles. t-statistics in parentheses; $^{*}p < 0.10$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$. Variable definitions are in Appendix A.

TABLE 8. The Accuracy Premium Across GPT-Capability Regimes

Panel A. Benchmark: equal-weighted five-FDP consensus

Regime:	(1) R0 Pre-ChatGPT	(2) R1 Text-only	(3) R2 Browsing	(4) R3 Native search
SUE^{Acc} (β_1)	1.376***	2.597***	3.753***	3.954***
	(3.45)	(3.38)	(6.19)	(5.69)
Benchmark SUE (β_2)	2.324***	2.419***	1.325***	1.404**
	(6.10)	(3.78)	(2.63)	(2.26)
Premium ($\beta_1 - \beta_2$)	**-0.948**	**0.178**	**2.429****	**2.550****
	(-1.28)	**(0.13)**	**(2.35)**	**(2.07)**
Controls	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Firm FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Observations	9,405	3,705	5,529	5,084
Adjusted R^2	0.085	0.158	0.151	0.140

Panel B. Benchmark: I/B/E/S consensus

Regime:	(1) R0 Pre-ChatGPT	(2) R1 Text-only	(3) R2 Browsing	(4) R3 Native search
SUE^{Acc} (β_1)	1.428***	1.918**	3.362***	5.079***
	(4.00)	(2.35)	(6.17)	(7.87)
Benchmark SUE (β_2)	2.176***	3.144***	1.842***	0.169
	(7.08)	(4.70)	(3.74)	(0.30)
Premium ($\beta_1 - \beta_2$)	**-0.747**	**-1.226**	**1.519**	**4.909*****
	(-1.20)	**(-0.86)**	**(1.61)**	**(4.41)**
Controls	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Firm FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Observations	9,405	3,705	5,529	5,084
Adjusted R^2	0.087	0.170	0.155	0.138

Notes. For each regime the specification is Equation (10) without the $Post_q$ interactions, with the market-adjusted $CAR_{[-1,1]}$ as the dependent variable, and the *Accuracy Premium* is the contrast $\beta_1 - \beta_2$. The benchmark X is the equal-weighted five-FDP consensus (Panel A) or I/B/E/S (Panel B). All columns include the firm and event controls, firm and year fixed effects (FE), and firm-clustered standard errors. Continuous variables are winsorized at the 1st and 99th percentiles. t-statistics in parentheses; $^{*}p < 0.10$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$. Variable definitions are in Appendix A.

TABLE 9. Cross-Sectional Tests of the Accuracy Premium

Panel A. Concurrent cross-FDP SUE dispersion

Benchmark:	Equal-Weighted		IBES	
	(1) Low	(2) High	(3) Low	(4) High
SUE^{Acc} (β_1)	4.138***	1.433***	1.569**	1.748***
	(6.37)	(4.23)	(2.43)	(5.57)
Benchmark SUE (β_2)	3.318***	2.024***	7.496***	1.560***
	(5.86)	(6.41)	(10.03)	(6.10)
$SUE^{Acc} \times Post^{Scr}$ (β_3)	2.748**	1.610***	1.439	1.746***
	(2.48)	(2.89)	(1.34)	(3.63)
Benchmark $SUE \times Post^{Scr}$ (β_4)	0.712	-0.602	2.130*	-0.681*
	(0.76)	(-1.20)	(1.86)	(-1.70)
Premium (Pre-Scrape)	0.821	-0.591	-5.927***	0.188
	(0.73)	(-0.96)	(-4.58)	(0.35)
Premium (Post-Scrape)	2.857*	1.620**	-6.619***	2.615***
	(1.71)	(1.98)	(-3.81)	(3.81)
Δ Premium (Post−Pre)	**2.037**	**2.211****	**-0.691**	**2.427*****
	(1.06)	**(2.21)**	**(-0.33)**	**(2.99)**
Controls	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Firm FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Observations	11,832	11,846	11,832	11,846
Adjusted R^2	0.111	0.075	0.127	0.075

Panel B. Special-items magnitude

Benchmark:	Equal-Weighted		IBES	
	(1) Low	(2) High	(3) Low	(4) High
SUE^{Acc} (β_1)	2.345***	1.613***	1.940***	1.969***
	(4.36)	(4.49)	(4.34)	(5.48)
Benchmark SUE (β_2)	2.153***	2.078***	2.465***	1.615***
	(4.21)	(6.41)	(6.46)	(5.25)
$SUE^{Acc} \times Post^{Scr}$ (β_3)	0.247	2.035***	0.440	2.583***
	(0.31)	(3.39)	(0.58)	(4.69)
Benchmark $SUE \times Post^{Scr}$ (β_4)	0.799	-0.483	0.659	-1.055**
	(1.14)	(-0.92)	(0.98)	(-2.28)
Premium (Pre-Scrape)	0.192	-0.464	-0.525	0.354
	(0.19)	(-0.74)	(-0.68)	(0.58)
Premium (Post-Scrape)	-0.360	2.054**	-0.743	3.992***
	(-0.28)	(2.48)	(-0.65)	(5.36)
Δ Premium (Post−Pre)	**-0.552**	**2.518****	**-0.219**	**3.638*****
	(-0.39)	**(2.40)**	**(-0.16)**	**(3.92)**
Controls	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Firm FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Observations	11,823	11,828	11,823	11,828
Adjusted R^2	0.089	0.073	0.095	0.071

Notes. This table estimates the accuracy-weighted horse race against the equal-weighted (EW5) and I/B/E/S benchmarks within two median splits: **Panel A** on *Cross-FDP SUE Dispersion* and **Panel B** on $|SpecItems|$ (%) (the control of the same name, scaled by market capitalization). Within each panel, columns (1)–(2) use SUE^{EW5} and columns (3)–(4) use SUE^{IBES}. The post-scraping indicator $Post^{Scr}$ replaces the post-ChatGPT *Post* of the other tables. The Accuracy Premium is the loading on SUE^{Acc} minus the loading on the benchmark SUE ($\beta_1 - \beta_2$ pre-scrape; $(\beta_1 + \beta_3) - (\beta_2 + \beta_4)$ post-scrape). The bolded Δ row reports the post-minus-pre change, $\beta_3 - \beta_4$. The dependent variable is the market-adjusted $CAR_{[-1,1]}$. All columns include the firm and event controls, firm and year fixed effects (FE), and firm-clustered standard errors. Each panel's sample comprises the firm-quarters with non-missing values for all regression variables. Continuous variables are winsorized at the 1st and 99th percentiles. t-statistics in parentheses; $^{*}p < 0.10$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$. Variable definitions are in Appendix A.

TABLE 10. LLM Visibility vs. Classical Prominence Proxies

Panel A. Overlap of high-visibility classifications

	LLM Visibility	Firm Size	Analyst Coverage	Inst Ownership
LLM Visibility	**1.000**	**0.502**	**0.497**	**0.471**
Firm Size	0.510	1.000	0.796	0.407
Analyst Coverage	0.506	0.798	1.000	0.445
Inst Ownership	0.479	0.407	0.445	1.000

Panel B. Accuracy-premium concentration: equal-weighted benchmark

Visibility measure	Univariate ΔPremium		Horse-race
	High group	Low group	triple diff.
LLM Visibility	**3.263*****	**0.300**	**3.172***
	(2.59)	**(0.25)**	**(1.80)**
	[11,219]	[11,825]	
Firm Size	0.723	2.447**	0.111
	(0.55)	(2.18)	(0.05)
	[11,901]	[11,143]	
Analyst Coverage	0.109	3.076**	-3.161
	(0.08)	(2.57)	(-1.38)
	[11,861]	[11,183]	
Inst Ownership	3.224**	0.646	3.222*
	(2.51)	(0.58)	(1.86)
	[11,593]	[11,451]	
Controls	Yes	Yes	Yes
Firm FE	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes
Observations	23,044		23,044

Panel C. Accuracy-premium concentration: I/B/E/S benchmark

Visibility measure	Univariate ΔPremium		Horse-race
	High group	Low group	triple diff.
LLM Visibility	**5.743*****	**-0.125**	**5.841*****
	(5.67)	**(-0.12)**	**(4.03)**
	[11,219]	[11,825]	
Firm Size	2.191	2.462***	2.010
	(1.28)	(2.76)	(0.82)
	[11,901]	[11,143]	
Analyst Coverage	0.441	3.198***	-4.099*
	(0.29)	(3.59)	(-1.77)
	[11,861]	[11,183]	
Inst Ownership	2.564**	2.418**	0.625
	(2.46)	(2.08)	(0.41)
	[11,593]	[11,451]	
Controls	Yes	Yes	Yes
Firm FE	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes
Observations	23,044		23,044

Notes. Each measure is split at its cross-firm median: LLM visibility, firm size (log market equity), analyst coverage (log average analyst count), and institutional ownership. The visibility score is discrete, so firms tied at the median join the Low group, which is why the split is not exactly even. **Panel A**: cell (i, j) is the proportion of firms in measure i's High group that measure j also classifies as High (diagonal = 1). **Panels B and C**: ΔPremium is the post-minus-pre change in the accuracy premium $\beta(SUE^{Acc}) - \beta(SUE^{X})$ against benchmark $X =$ the equal-weighted five-FDP consensus (Panel B) or I/B/E/S (Panel C), estimated within each measure's High and Low group. The horse-race triple $(SUE^{Acc} - SUE^{X}) \times Post^{\text{Scr}} \times High_m$ is from one pooled regression including the triple for every measure jointly. Throughout, $Post^{\text{Scr}}$ is the post-scraping indicator, as in Table 9. The dependent variable throughout Panels B and C is the market-adjusted $CAR_{[-1,1]}$. All specifications include the firm and event controls, firm and year fixed effects (FE), and firm-clustered standard errors. Continuous variables are winsorized at the 1st and 99th percentiles. t-statistics in parentheses and group observation counts in brackets (each measure's High and Low groups partition the same 23,044 firm-quarters, the announcements with non-missing values for all regression variables); $^{*}p < 0.10$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$. Variable definitions are in Appendix A.

TABLE 11. LLM Visibility and the Accuracy Premium by GPT-Capability Regime

Panel A. Equal-weighted five-FDP benchmark

Regime:	(1) R0 Pre-ChatGPT	(2) R1 Text-only	(3) R2 Browsing	(4) R3 Native search
SUE^{Acc} (β_1)	1.361**	3.503***	3.077***	3.055***
	(2.57)	(5.05)	(2.95)	(4.18)
SUE^{EW5} (β_2)	2.252***	2.185***	1.885***	2.002***
	(4.09)	(3.61)	(3.65)	(3.21)
$SUE^{Acc} \times High\,Visibility$ (β_3)	0.020	-2.274	1.550*	1.815*
	(0.05)	(-1.49)	(1.79)	(1.93)
$SUE^{EW5} \times High\,Visibility$ (β_4)	0.153	0.889	-1.133**	-1.269
	(0.28)	(0.79)	(-2.11)	(-1.51)
Accuracy premium = loading on SUE^{Acc} − loading on benchmark *SUE*:				
Premium (Low Vis)	-0.892	1.317	1.192	1.053
	(-0.90)	(1.12)	(0.89)	(0.83)
Premium (High Vis)	-1.025	-1.845	3.875***	4.136***
	(-1.57)	(-0.94)	(4.60)	(4.16)
Premium (High − Low)	**-0.133**	**-3.163**	**2.683****	**3.083***
	(-0.15)	**(-1.22)**	**(2.12)**	**(1.85)**
Controls	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Firm FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year-qtr FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Observations	9,399	3,705	5,529	5,084
Adjusted R^2	0.086	0.163	0.165	0.143

Panel B. I/B/E/S benchmark

Regime:	(1) R0 Pre-ChatGPT	(2) R1 Text-only	(3) R2 Browsing	(4) R3 Native search
SUE^{Acc} (β_1)	1.607***	3.138***	2.737***	4.029***
	(4.07)	(3.15)	(6.05)	(8.81)
SUE^{IBES} (β_2)	1.859***	2.424***	2.403**	0.974**
	(3.60)	(2.96)	(2.28)	(2.13)
$SUE^{Acc} \times High\,Visibility$ (β_3)	-0.382	-2.353*	1.667**	2.376***
	(-1.03)	(-1.74)	(2.44)	(3.68)
$SUE^{IBES} \times High\,Visibility$ (β_4)	0.669	1.362	-1.380	-1.856***
	(0.97)	(1.45)	(-1.45)	(-3.06)
Accuracy premium = loading on SUE^{Acc} − loading on benchmark *SUE*:				
Premium (Low Vis)	-0.252	0.714	0.335	3.054***
	(-0.31)	(0.41)	(0.26)	(4.00)
Premium (High Vis)	-1.303**	-3.001**	3.382***	7.286***
	(-2.06)	(-2.12)	(6.17)	(10.56)
Premium (High − Low)	**-1.052**	**-3.715***	**3.047****	**4.232*****
	(-1.07)	**(-1.72)**	**(2.05)**	**(3.93)**
Controls	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Firm FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year-qtr FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Observations	9,399	3,705	5,529	5,084
Adjusted R^2	0.088	0.175	0.169	0.142

Notes. This table estimates, separately within each GPT-capability regime (R0–R3; Appendix A), the horse race of Equation (11). **Panel A** uses the equal-weighted five-FDP benchmark SUE^{EW5} and **Panel B** uses the I/B/E/S benchmark. The Accuracy Premium (the loading on SUE^{Acc} minus the loading on the benchmark) is $\beta_1 - \beta_2$ for low-visibility firms and $(\beta_1 + \beta_3) - (\beta_2 + \beta_4)$ for high-visibility firms. The bolded Premium (High − Low) row is the triple difference $\beta_3 - \beta_4$. The dependent variable is the market-adjusted $CAR_{[-1,1]}$. All columns include the firm and event controls and firm and year-quarter fixed effects (FE), with standard errors two-way clustered by firm and calendar year. Each regime sample comprises the announcements with non-missing values for all regression variables. Continuous variables are winsorized at the 1st and 99th percentiles. t-statistics in parentheses; $^{*}p < 0.10$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$. Variable definitions are in Appendix A.

TABLE 12. Additional Tests of the Accuracy Premium

Panel A. The timing of the premium within the post-period

	Equal-weighted five-FDP		I/B/E/S	
Post-period from browsing: Δ Premium	**1.766****	**(2.04)**	**2.476*****	**(3.21)**
Both boundaries: Δ Premium at release	**2.256***	**(1.87)**	**1.784**	**(1.61)**
Both boundaries: Δ Premium at browsing	**0.216**	**(0.18)**	**1.236**	**(1.13)**
Both boundaries: cumulative Δ Premium	**2.472*****	**(2.62)**	**3.020*****	**(3.62)**

Panel B. The response to each provider's own surprise

	ERC before ChatGPT		Post-ChatGPT increment	
I/B/E/S	3.022***	(16.05)	0.694**	(2.57)
FactSet	2.783***	(13.73)	0.676**	(2.45)
Bloomberg	1.102***	(9.48)	0.179	(1.24)
Capital IQ	3.247***	(15.86)	0.687**	(2.47)
Zacks	3.618***	(16.94)	1.452***	(4.72)

Panel C. The crowd consensus: the premium over the Estimize consensus

	Market-adjusted CAR		FFC CAR	
Premium over the Estimize consensus, R3	**5.067****	**(2.38)**	**5.448****	**(2.57)**
Change in that premium, R0 to R3	**5.164*****	**(2.81)**	**5.195*****	**(2.81)**

Panel D. The results without Bloomberg (four providers)

	Equal-weighted four-FDP		I/B/E/S	
Premium (Pre-ChatGPT)	-3.573***	(-2.62)	1.565**	(2.11)
Premium (Post-ChatGPT)	0.982	(0.68)	4.804***	(6.14)
Δ Premium (Post−Pre)	**4.555****	**(2.41)**	**3.239*****	**(3.22)**

Panel E. Which investors benefit more

	Equal-weighted five-FDP		I/B/E/S	
High minus low Δ Premium at the pre-ChatGPT median of:				
Retail share of trading	**1.284**	**(0.72)**	**1.453**	**(0.95)**
Institutional ownership	**1.757**	**(1.00)**	**0.482**	**(0.31)**
Analyst coverage	**-7.281*****	**(-4.28)**	**-1.849**	**(-1.14)**
Pre-announcement spread response to the accuracy tilt, high visibility:				
Quoted spread (log ratio)	**-0.019**	**(-0.79)**	**-0.030**	**(-1.33)**
Effective spread (log ratio)	**-0.001**	**(-0.04)**	**-0.017**	**(-0.68)**

Notes. The sample is the 23,833 firm-quarters unless noted. Panels A, C, D, and E test the accuracy premium (the loading of the market-adjusted $CAR_{[-1,1]}$ on SUE^{Acc} minus that on the benchmark surprise), and Panel B each provider's ERC in one regression per provider. Panel A starts the post-period at browsing (September 27, 2023) and, with both boundaries, estimates the change at each and their sum. Panel C reports, on the firm-quarters with an Estimize consensus (2,564 under native search, 13,791 in all), the premium over the Estimize consensus under native search (R3) and its change from the pre-ChatGPT regime (R0), under the market-adjusted and FFC $CAR_{[-1,1]}$. Its benchmark surprise SUE^{Est} is the Estimize reported EPS minus the consensus of the day before the announcement (at least three estimates, at most 30 days old), scaled by the price that scales SUE. Panel D repeats the pooled horse race of Table 7 with the four providers other than Bloomberg (23,832 firm-quarters), SUE^{Acc4} with the weights of Section 3.5 computed across the four and SUE^{EW4} their mean. Panel E estimates each high-minus-low difference in a pooled regression per characteristic and benchmark (23,476 firm-quarters for the retail share, 23,515 for the other two). Its spread rows report the coefficient on Accuracy Tilt $\times$ $Post^{Scr}$ $\times$ High Visibility for the abnormal spread (23,215 firm-quarters). All regressions include the firm and event controls and firm and year fixed effects, with firm-clustered t-statistics in parentheses; $^{*}p < 0.10$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$. Variable definitions are in Appendix A.

Online Appendix

Synthesizing the Consensus: Generative AI and the Pricing of Multi-Provider Earnings Forecasts

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This Online Appendix contains supplementary material for the paper:

- **Online Appendix A: The LLM Visibility Query and an Integration-Prompt Pilot**
  - A.1 The Query Behind LLM Visibility and the Providers Behind the Cited Sites
  - A.2 An Integration-Prompt Pilot
- **Online Appendix B: The Accuracy-Weighted SUE, Optimal Synthesis, and the Pricing Model**
  - B.1 Numerical Illustration of the Accuracy-Weighted SUE
  - B.2 Optimal Synthesis Across Providers
  - B.3 The Pricing Model and the Stability of Cross-Provider Dynamics
- **Online Appendix C: Supplementary Details**
  - C.1 Institutional Background of the Five Providers
  - C.2 The Analyst Revision Sample and the Herding Specification
  - C.3 The Predictive-Value Measure and Its Alternatives
  - C.4 Which Investors Benefit More from GenAI
  - C.5 Search Traffic to the GenAI Tools

Online Appendix A: The LLM Visibility Query and an Integration-Prompt Pilot

This appendix first describes the query behind the LLM visibility measure of Section 6.2 and reports the providers that the cited sites name as the sources of their estimates (A.1). It then presents a pilot in which browsing models are asked to rank and weight the cited sites by accuracy (A.2).

A.1 The Query Behind LLM Visibility and the Providers Behind the Cited Sites

The query asks ChatGPT (`gpt-4o-2024-08-06` with web search) for a firm's next-quarter consensus EPS and for every source that publishes one, with each source's name, estimate, number of contributing analysts, and URL, together with the firm's next earnings date and its most recent reported EPS. Each response returns the sources it cites, and the measure counts these source citations, repeats included. The responses behind the measure are issued three times per firm on May 28 and June 1, 2026 (Section 6.2). Table OA2 reports, for the 17 sites that receive 88.7 percent of the citations in the May 28 run, the provider that each site names as the source of its estimates. Of the five providers, the sites name only Zacks and S&P Global Market Intelligence, the publisher of the Capital IQ consensus, as their current sources.

A.2 An Integration-Prompt Pilot

The paper defines synthesis as three steps, retrieving each provider's consensus and actual, evaluating each provider's quality from its past performance for the firm, and weighting the surprises by that assessment (Section 2.2). The GPT-capability regimes and the LLM visibility measure vary only the first step, so this subsection asks whether a browsing model performs the other two when asked. If models could only retrieve, the investor would have to weight the providers by accuracy by hand, and the cost reduction on which the framework rests would be partial. On October 9, 2026, I send two prompts, P1 in free text and P2 in a fixed JSON format, to ChatGPT (`gpt-6.1-sol` with web search) and to Perplexity (`sonar`) for 50 sample firms, IBM, Microsoft, and 48 drawn from the grid of visibility halves and size terciles, asking for each site's consensus and reported EPS for the four quarters reported in 2025, its mean absolute error, a ranking and weights of the sites by accuracy, and an accuracy-weighted consensus for the next quarter. Table OA1 reports the results. The histories that ChatGPT retrieves match one of the five providers' own actuals within two cents

at a mean rate of 98 percent per response, and it completes the chain to an accuracy-weighted consensus in 28 to 62 percent of its responses depending on the prompt, Perplexity in 24 percent of its P2 responses. The pilot covers 50 firms with a model later than the sample period's, so it shows capability at the time of the pilot, not use during the sample. The completion rate also depends on the prompt's wording, at 35 percent of the 100 P2 responses (two pulls per firm), whose system message requires every number to come from a cited page, against 62 percent once an amended message lets the model compute the errors, ranking, weights, and weighted consensus (prompt P2b).

Online Appendix B: The Accuracy-Weighted SUE, Optimal Synthesis, and the Pricing Model

This appendix first illustrates how the accuracy-weighted SUE is constructed for a single firm-quarter (B.1). It then derives the expectation that an investor forms from the five providers' consensus forecasts and what synthesis buys over a single provider and over equal weighting (B.2). Finally, it gives a pricing model under which the accuracy premium is a demand-side object and shows that the cross-provider structure on which the weights operate is stable (B.3).

B.1 Numerical Illustration of the Accuracy-Weighted SUE

Suppose firm i in quarter q has the following backward-looking accuracy histories ($Acc^g_{i,q} = -MAFE^g_{i,q}$ over the prior four quarters, in price-scaled units) across the five FDPs (the z-scores use the sample standard deviation across the five providers), alongside their current-quarter standardized surprises $SUE^g_{i,q}$ (in percent of price).

Provider g	$Acc^g_{i,q}$	$Acc_z^g_{i,q}$	$\exp(Acc_z^g_{i,q})$	$w^g_{i,q}$
IBES	-0.0010	1.26	3.54	0.49
FactSet	-0.0020	0.63	1.88	0.26
Capital IQ	-0.0030	0.00	1.00	0.14
Zacks	-0.0040	-0.63	0.53	0.07
Bloomberg	-0.0050	-1.26	0.28	0.04
Sum			7.24	1.00

I/B/E/S has the smallest absolute forecast error (largest Acc^g) and therefore the highest within-row z-score, which the softmax transform maps to the largest weight (0.49). Bloomberg has the largest absolute forecast error and receives the smallest weight (0.04). The weights sum to one and reduce to the uniform 0.20 vector when the five accuracy scores are equal.

Provider g	$SUE^{g}_{i,q}$	$w^{g}_{i,q} \times SUE^{g}_{i,q}$	$0.20 \times SUE^{g}_{i,q}$
IBES	1.20	0.59	0.24
FactSet	0.80	0.21	0.16
Capital IQ	1.00	0.14	0.20
Zacks	1.50	0.11	0.30
Bloomberg	-0.50	-0.02	-0.10
Total		$SUE^{Acc}_{i,q} = 1.02$	$SUE^{EW5}_{i,q} = 0.80$

Entries are rounded to two decimals while the totals are computed from unrounded weights, so the displayed cells need not sum exactly to the reported totals. The accuracy-weighted composite $SUE^{Acc}_{i,q} = 1.02$ exceeds the equal-weighted composite $SUE^{EW5}_{i,q} = 0.80$ for two reasons. I/B/E/S, with a weight of 0.49 against 0.20, reports a surprise of 1.20, and the low weight on Bloomberg removes most of its surprise of -0.50. These two contributions outweigh the low weight on Zacks's surprise of 1.50, the largest in the row. The accuracy tilt $SUE^{Acc}_{i,q} - SUE^{EW5}_{i,q} = 0.22$ captures the accuracy-driven correction. In the horse-race regression of Table 7, this tilt is the source of identification between the two composites. When the tilt is informative about announcement-window returns beyond the equal-weighted aggregate, the market is loading on provider-specific accuracy instead of treating all five FDPs symmetrically.

B.2 Optimal Synthesis Across Providers

A simple model illustrates why synthesizing the providers' consensus forecasts can benefit investors. Following the forecast-combination logic of Bates and Granger (1969), consider an investor who uses the forecasts to estimate the earnings revealed at the announcement. The investor seeks to minimize expected squared forecast error.

Fix a firm-quarter and suppress its subscripts. Let provider g's consensus forecast be

$$s^g = x + u + v^g, \qquad g = 1, \ldots, K,$$

where x is realized earnings, u is a common forecast error, and v^g is a provider-specific forecast

error.[52] Assume that all errors have mean zero, that the provider-specific errors are mutually uncorrelated and uncorrelated with u, and that $\mathrm{Var}(u) = \sigma_u^2$ and $\mathrm{Var}(v^g) = a_g > 0$. For the benchmark, take these variances as known.

The investor forms a combined forecast $c(w) = \sum_g w_g s^g$, with $\sum_g w_g = 1$. Its expected squared error is

$$\mathrm{E}\big[(c(w) - x)^2\big] = \sigma_u^2 + \sum_g w_g^2 a_g.$$

Combining forecasts cannot remove the common error, but it can reduce provider-specific noise. Minimizing this expression gives

$$w_g^* = \frac{a_g^{-1}}{\sum_h a_h^{-1}}, \qquad \mathrm{E}\big[(c(w^*) - x)^2\big] = \sigma_u^2 + \frac{1}{\sum_g a_g^{-1}}. \tag{B1}$$

More reliable providers receive greater weight, while the investor retains information from the other providers.

This combination improves on the most accurate single provider:

$$\sigma_u^2 + \frac{1}{\sum_g a_g^{-1}} < \sigma_u^2 + \min_g a_g,$$

provided that at least two providers have finite, strictly positive provider-specific error variances. For example, if all five providers have the same provider-specific error variance a, averaging reduces that component of forecast error from a to $a/5$. The common error variance remains unchanged.

Accuracy weighting also weakly improves on equal weighting:

$$\sigma_u^2 + \frac{1}{\sum_g a_g^{-1}} \leq \sigma_u^2 + \frac{1}{K^2} \sum_g a_g,$$

by the Cauchy–Schwarz inequality, with equality only when all a_g are equal. Thus, combining providers can improve accuracy even when they are equally reliable. Assigning different weights provides an additional benefit when their reliabilities differ.

The model gives investors a mathematical reason to synthesize consensus forecasts: different providers contain some distinct information, and combining them reduces the influence of

[52] The common error u is included for realism, as providers may share analyst inputs or forecasting mistakes. The same optimal weights and comparisons with the most accurate single provider and equal weighting obtain when $u = 0$. The common error adds the same σ_u^2 to each forecast's expected squared error, leaving the optimal weights and absolute accuracy gains unchanged.

provider-specific errors. The empirical procedure in Section 3.5 implements this intuition by assigning greater weight to providers with better trailing accuracy. Its estimated weights need not equal the population-optimal weights above, so the resulting accuracy gains are assessed empirically in Table 6.

B.3 The Pricing Model and the Stability of Cross-Provider Dynamics

Consensus forecasts become more accurate over 2021–2025, whether from secular improvement in analyst research, from GenAI assistance reaching the analysts whose forecasts feed all five FDPs, or from shifting sample composition. If the premium tracked this trend, it would say nothing about how the market synthesizes providers. This subsection gives a pricing model under which the premium is a demand-side object and shows that the cross-provider structure on which the weights operate is stable.

Write each provider's surprise as $SUE^{g}_{i,q} = N_{i,q} + \eta^{g}_{i,q}$, where $N_{i,q}$ is the value-relevant earnings news of announcement (i,q) and the measurement components η^{g} may have any joint distribution and any drift over time. The supply side, forecast accuracy and its evolution, is captured by $\{\eta^{g}\}$. Two properties separate demand from supply.

First, the construction is supply-invariant. Because Equation (3) standardizes accuracy within firm-quarter before the softmax, replacing $MAFE^{g}_{i,q}$ by $a_{i,q}MAFE^{g}_{i,q} + b_{i,q}$ $(a_{i,q} > 0)$ uniformly across the five providers leaves every weight $w^{g}_{i,q}$ unchanged.

Second, let the market's pre-announcement expectation of street earnings be a convex combination of the two candidate consensus benchmarks, $E^{m}_{i,q} = \omega\, Consensus^{Acc}_{i,q} + (1-\omega)\, Consensus^{X}_{i,q}$, where $Consensus^{Acc}_{i,q} = \sum_{g} w^{g}_{i,q}\, Consensus^{g}_{i,q}$ is the accuracy-weighted consensus level, $Consensus^{X}_{i,q}$ is the comparison benchmark's, $X \in \{EW5, IBES\}$, and ω is the market's relative reliance on the accuracy-weighted synthesis, the direct analog of the expectation mixture in Walther (1997). Each provider's consensus pairs with its own street actual (Section 3.5), so the surprise inherits the same mixture and the return equation is

$$CAR_{i,q} \;=\; \theta\left[\omega\, SUE^{Acc}_{i,q} \;+\; (1-\omega)\, SUE^{X}_{i,q}\right] \;+\; \varepsilon_{i,q}, \tag{B2}$$

where θ is the return response per unit of perceived surprise (Holthausen and Verrecchia, 1988; Kim

and Verrecchia, 1991) and ε collects pricing components outside the span of the two benchmarks. Equation (B2) reparameterizes the horse-race slopes period by period ($\theta = \beta_1 + \beta_2$ and $\omega = \beta_1/(\beta_1 + \beta_2)$ before ChatGPT, with $\beta_1 + \beta_3$ and $\beta_2 + \beta_4$ in their place after) and imposes no restriction. The accuracy premium in each period is therefore $\beta_{Acc} - \beta_X = \theta\,(2\omega - 1)$, linear in ω given θ. Neither the level of forecast accuracy nor its improvement appears in it, so the supply side can reach the premium only through ω, the market's choice. In these units, the pre- and post-period slopes of Table 7, Panel A, imply $\omega = 0.37$ before ChatGPT and 0.66 after.

The improvement in accuracy is common to the providers, not a convergence among them. With firm fixed effects, the log realized error is 10.1 log points lower under browsing ($t = 4.0$) and 10.6 lower under native search ($t = 3.8$), with no change in the text-only regime (untabulated). Panel C of Table OA3 reports the distribution of the *ex ante* most accurate provider by regime. Across the three post-ChatGPT regimes, the period over which the premium emerges, the distribution shows no significant change ($\chi^2(8) = 10.8$, $p = 0.21$). A one-time step down in Bloomberg's share at the ChatGPT boundary (17.2 to 14.5 percent in Panel C) predates the premium's emergence at browsing and is the kind of reordering that the trailing-MAFE weights track.

The relative structure keeps its predictive validity. The within-firm-quarter rank correlation between the trailing-MAFE ordering and the realized error ordering of the announcement quarter is 0.217 in R0 and 0.215 in R3, with the R3-minus-R0 difference statistically indistinguishable from zero ($t = 0.0$; untabulated). A transient dip in the text-only regime (-0.034, $t = 2.7$; untabulated) has recovered by the regimes in which the premium appears.

Two further tests support the construct. In untabulated paired tests, the accuracy-weighted composite's absolute standardized surprise is smaller than either benchmark's in both periods ($t > 10$). In an untabulated stacked panel of the four providers with native point-in-time history (Bloomberg's begins only in 2020Q2), which regresses four-quarter-ahead earnings and cash flows on each provider's consensus with provider intercepts, industry effects, and firm-clustered standard errors, the consensus slopes are statistically indistinguishable across providers, so tilting weights toward accurate providers loses no detectable predictive content.

Online Appendix C: Supplementary Details

This appendix carries the detail behind five parts of the paper: the five providers' institutional background (C.1), the analyst revision sample and herding specification (C.2), the predictive-value measure and its alternatives (C.3), which investors benefit more from GenAI (C.4), and the search traffic to the GenAI tools behind the regime timing (C.5).

C.1 Institutional Background of the Five Providers

This subsection gives the providers' origins and the evidence on the basis of Bloomberg's reported actual that Section 3.1 summarizes. I/B/E/S is credited with creating the consensus-earnings-estimate industry in the early 1970s, and Zacks claims to have first distributed quarterly consensus forecasts in the early 1980s. Bloomberg, Capital IQ, and FactSet entered the segment from adjacent product lines (Larocque et al., 2026). Beyond the pairwise disagreement of Table OA3, all five providers report the same actual in only 6.3 percent of firm-quarters, and the largest cross-provider gap reaches at least five cents per share in 78 percent (untabulated). The Bloomberg actual in these data behaves like a GAAP basic EPS figure, while Bloomberg's consensus forecasts street earnings. It is within two cents of another provider's actual in only 23 to 25 percent of firm-quarters, pair by pair, against 66 to 88 percent for the other provider pairs (untabulated). It is within two cents of Compustat's basic EPS excluding extraordinary items in 54.5 percent of firm-quarters, against 28.5 to 32.7 percent for the other providers' actuals (untabulated). In 541 of the 1,334 sample firms, it matches the basic EPS of a quarter one or two quarters away from its label in 94.5 percent of firm-quarters (untabulated). Bloomberg's own consensus is closer to Capital IQ's actual than to Bloomberg's (median absolute errors of 0.136 and 0.248 percent of price; untabulated). Bloomberg's surprise therefore contains the gap between the two bases as well as the forecast error. The accuracy weights discount much of this noise, because Bloomberg has the largest trailing forecast error of the five providers in 62 percent of firm-quarters, in which its mean weight is 0.024 (untabulated). By contrast, in the 16 percent of firm-quarters in which its trailing error is the smallest, its mean weight is 0.62 (untabulated). The main tests keep Bloomberg in the composite because a street-basis Bloomberg actual is not available in these data.

Panel D of Table 12 repeats the pooled horse race of Table 7 without Bloomberg.

C.2 The Analyst Revision Sample and the Herding Specification

This subsection describes the analyst revision sample and the herding specification of Section 4.2, whose estimates are in Table 4. A revision pairs consecutive forecasts by the same analyst for the same firm-quarter, issued within the 180 days preceding the announcement and no more than 120 days apart. The sample contains 170,956 revisions by 2,283 analysts covering 759 firms, of which 122,001 with the full firm and analyst control sets enter the regressions (120,868 in the analyst–firm pair specifications). The benchmark is the prevailing I/B/E/S summary consensus that analysts observe, the mean estimate from the most recent statistical-period summary strictly preceding the revision date (at most 45 days old, at least three estimates). The regressions of Section 4.2 interact $Post_q$ with the $IBES\,Up_i$ and $IBES\,Down_i$ indicators of Table 3 (β_1 and β_2) or, in columns (3)–(4) of Table 4, with the three post-ChatGPT GPT-capability regimes ($\beta_{1,r}$ and $\beta_{2,r}$). Appendix A defines the analyst controls of Clement (1999). The distance fixed effects are twenty ventiles of the price-scaled distance between the analyst's prior and the consensus, and standard errors cluster by firm. Because the partition is defined by the rank change over the full post-period, a decline in every regime is expected. The regime split is therefore descriptive, and the pooled columns provide the formal test.

C.3 The Predictive-Value Measure and Its Alternatives

This subsection describes the predictive-value measure of Section 4.3, two alternative explanations for the post-ChatGPT increment, and the relation between predictive value and trailing accuracy. The building block is the residual of Equation (6), the year-ahead street actual net of its fitted value. The regression pairs the I/B/E/S consensus with the same provider's street actual because the providers' street actuals disagree pervasively (see Table OA3 for details). A pair of quarters s and $s+4$ enters only if no stock split falls between them. The fitted intercept and slope absorb a level bias and a scale error, so the measure scores how closely a linear function of the consensus tracks the year-ahead actual. Predictive value is a continuous cross-firm variable (mean 0.67, standard deviation 0.25). It is negative for the 2 percent of firm-quarters whose

summed absolute residuals exceed their summed absolute actuals. It covers 22,364 of the 23,833 firm-quarters (8,730 pre-ChatGPT), of which 22,356 enter the regressions. The window holds the full twenty source quarters for 21,140 of the 22,364. The test covers the I/B/E/S consensus alone, because the measure requires up to twenty quarters of realized year-ahead outcomes and the five-FDP panel is too short to supply them for every FDP. Two alternative explanations for the increment of Table 5 receive little support. The first is announcement composition. Adding the large-unexpected-item flag of Bochkay et al. (2022) with its full set of interactions leaves the increment at 3.14 ($t = 3.60$). The flag is nearly uncorrelated with predictive value (-0.02; both untabulated). The second is selection toward I/B/E/S specifically. In an untabulated decomposition of the surprise into the component common to the four providers other than Bloomberg and the I/B/E/S-specific tilt, the common component carries both the gradient (3.0, $t = 4.1$) and its post-ChatGPT increment (2.7, $t = 2.5$) on the market-adjusted $CAR_{[-1,1]}$. Applied at the current-quarter horizon, the same procedure yields a like-for-like measure of the consensus's trailing accuracy, and across firms the two are highly correlated (Pearson 0.72, Spearman 0.75; 0.79 correcting for split-half measurement error; untabulated).

C.4 Which Investors Benefit More from GenAI

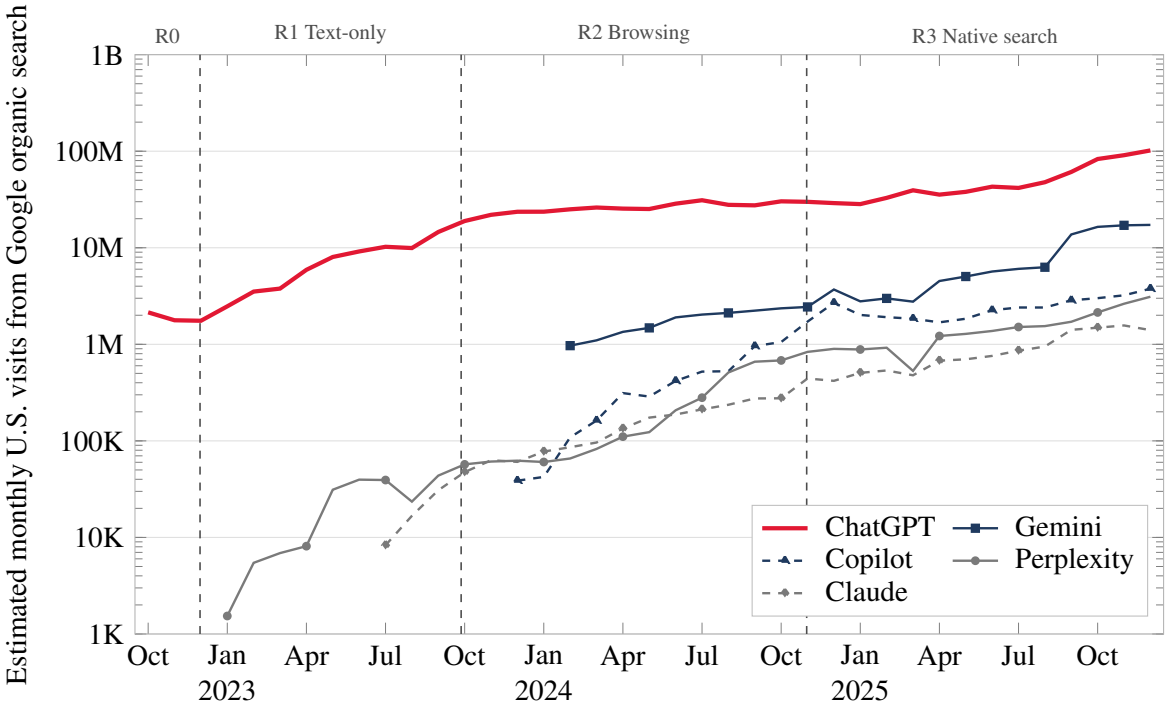
This subsection reports the trading tests of Section 7.6, which are untabulated. Panel E of Table 12 reports the section's median splits and spread test. Trading by investor type identifies no investor group, because no group's order flow, trading volume, or fund holdings shift toward the accuracy-weighted surprise against both benchmarks at the five-percent level. The variables of the trading tests are defined in Appendix A, Panel E.

C.5 Search Traffic to the GenAI Tools

This subsection reports the search-traffic evidence behind the regime timing of Section 3.3: among the GenAI tools that DataForSEO tracks, ChatGPT is the primary retrieval tool and the dominant one through December 2025. Figure OA1 plots the estimated monthly visits that each tool receives from Google organic search in the United States, October 2022 to December 2025. When browsing returns in September 2023, ChatGPT receives 334 times as many of these visits

as Perplexity. At the launch of ChatGPT search, in October 2024, it receives 12.8 times as many as the next-largest tracked tool. By December 2025, the ratio is 5.9 relative to Gemini. In every month of the window, ChatGPT draws more of these visits than the other tracked tools together. The measure counts visits that arrive through Google search results, not total usage or investor adoption, and Bing Chat and Bard are absent from the source.

FIGURE OA1. Monthly Organic Search Traffic to GenAI Tools



Notes. This figure compares the adoption of ChatGPT with the adoption of the other GenAI tools that launch near the regime boundaries. Each line plots a tool's estimated monthly visits from Google organic search results in the United States (DataForSEO), October 2022 to December 2025, on a logarithmic scale. The measure counts visits that arrive through Google search results, not total visits. ChatGPT is the sum of `openai.com` and `chatgpt.com`, because the product moved from `chat.openai.com` to `chatgpt.com` in mid-2024. The ChatGPT line therefore includes visits to `openai.com` in October and November 2022, before ChatGPT's launch. Before June 2024, `chatgpt.com` registers fewer than 34,000 visits a month. Gemini is `gemini.google.com`, the name Bard took in February 2024, and Copilot is `copilot.microsoft.com`, live since November 2023. Each line starts in the first month with at least 1,000 estimated visits. Bing Chat (February 2023) and Bard (March 2023) are not in the source, which has no `bing.com` or `bard.google.com` series. The dashed vertical lines mark the starts of the GPT-capability regimes R1, R2, and R3 of Appendix A (November 30, 2022; September 27, 2023; October 31, 2024).

TABLE OA1. Integration-Prompt Pilot: What the Models Do When Asked

Model	Prompt	N	Share of responses with					Actual match
			(a)	(b)	(c)	(d)	(a)–(d)	
ChatGPT `gpt-6.1-sol`	P1	100	0.77	0.67	0.63	0.34	0.28	0.97
ChatGPT `gpt-6.1-sol`	P2	100	0.81	0.64	0.52	0.40	0.35	0.98
ChatGPT `gpt-6.1-sol`	P2b	50	0.82	0.74	0.96	0.78	0.62	0.98
Perplexity `sonar`	P1	50	0.30	0.34	0.14	0.20	0.06	0.77
Perplexity `sonar`	P2	50	0.72	0.42	0.40	0.36	0.24	0.90

Notes. N is the number of responses (firm-pulls) per model and prompt. P2b is the P2 user prompt with the amended system message of Online Appendix A.2, run on ChatGPT only. Of its 50 responses, one per firm, 17 come from a run on October 11, 2026 (UTC) that repeats the failed calls with the same prompt text. In 16 of these 17, the model notes the later date and takes October 9 as the reference date. Columns (a) to (d) give the share of responses that (a) report a consensus and a reported EPS for at least two quarters for each of at least two sites, (b) rank at least two sites by accuracy, (c) assign at least two numeric weights that sum to one (0.9 to 1.1, or 90 to 110 percent), and (d) report a numeric accuracy-weighted consensus. Column (a)–(d) gives the share of responses that meet all four. Actual match is the mean, over responses with at least one claimed reported EPS in the firm's 2025 announcement window, of the share of those claims within $0.02 of the own-basis actual of any of the five providers for that firm and quarter. The table reports no agreement between the models' rankings of sites and the providers' accuracy ranks, because the grade A or B rows of Table OA2 valid on October 9, 2026 map 8 domains, all to S&P Capital IQ or Zacks, so no response ranks two mapped sites with different providers.

TABLE OA2. Upstream Providers Disclosed by the Sites That the Model Cites

Site	Share of citations (%)	Disclosed provider	Grade
marketbeat.com	21.5	Fiscal.ai	
chartmill.com	20.0	None named	
alphaquery.com	6.1	Zacks Investment Research, Inc.	A
businessquant.com	6.0	Business Quant (self-attribution, no vendor named)	
marketxls.com	5.8	MarketXLS (self-attribution only, no estimate vendor named)	
barchart.com	4.8	Zacks (spelled "Zack's" on the page). The page footer says 'Fundamental data provided by Zacks and Morningstar'	A
benzinga.com	4.3	None named	
fxempire.com	4.1	None named	
tipranks.com	4.1	None named for EPS or revenue estimates. The FAQ describes TipRanks' own collection of analyst ratings	
coincodex.com	3.9	None named	
zacks.com	3.3	Zacks (its own consensus database, compiled from brokerage feeds)	B
stockanalysis.com	3.0	S&P Global Market Intelligence (consensus and forecasts) and TipRanks (individual analyst data)	A
investing.com	1.0	None named	
finance.yahoo.com	0.4	S&P Global Market Intelligence, from 2025-01-29	B
finance.yahoo.com	0.4	LSEG Data and Analytics (called Refinitiv in the 2022-12-16 and 2023-10-01 copies), until 2025-01-20	B
nasdaq.com	0.1	Zacks Investment Research	A
seekingalpha.com	0.1	S&P Global Market Intelligence	B
fiscal.ai	0.0	S&P Market Intelligence LLC and its suppliers, for 'certain financials and estimates'. The API terms say only 'Third-Party suppliers'	B

Notes. Share of citations is the site's share of the 51,933 citations in the 3,912 responses of the May 28 run of the queries behind the LLM visibility measure (Section 6.2). The 17 sites receive 88.7 percent of the citations. Grade A means that the site's estimates page names the provider, grade B that a help, methodology, data-source, or terms page does, and a blank grade that the site names none of the five forecast data providers. Each grade rests on the site's own methodology or data-attribution page, and the replication file `distributor_fdp_mapping_sourced.csv` records each page's URL. Yahoo Finance has two rows because its help page names LSEG Data and Analytics in copies up to January 20, 2025 and S&P Global Market Intelligence from January 29, 2025. MarketBeat credits its estimates to Fiscal.ai, whose terms name S&P Global Market Intelligence only for certain financials and estimates, so the table leaves MarketBeat undisclosed. Counting MarketBeat as an S&P site would raise the share of citations that go to sites carrying S&P's estimates from 3.5 to 25.1 percent.

TABLE OA3. Street-Actual Disagreement and Provider Accuracy Shares Across FDPs and GPT-Capability Regimes

Panel A. Pairwise disagreement over the 23,833 sample firm-quarters (percent)

	I/B/E/S	FactSet	Bloomberg	Zacks
FactSet	22.27			
Bloomberg	88.50	88.66		
Zacks	33.63	38.30	90.84	
Capital IQ	16.31	21.06	88.95	32.41

Panel B. Pairwise disagreement by GPT-capability regime (percent)

Regime:	(1) R0 Pre-ChatGPT	(2) R1 Text-only	(3) R2 Browsing	(4) R3 Native search	*t*-statistic R1−R0	*t*-statistic R2−R1	Joint *p*
I/B/E/S–FactSet	24.62	23.11	22.15	17.47	-4.09	0.03	0.000
I/B/E/S–Bloomberg	88.49	87.95	88.88	88.52	-1.03	1.64	0.357
I/B/E/S–Zacks	32.89	34.27	34.21	33.92	2.27	0.28	0.066
I/B/E/S–Capital IQ	17.02	16.36	16.10	15.22	-1.04	-1.28	0.021
FactSet–Bloomberg	88.86	87.84	88.64	88.91	-2.08	1.83	0.022
FactSet–Zacks	38.63	39.25	38.86	36.42	-0.37	1.44	0.502
FactSet–Capital IQ	23.17	22.12	20.89	16.61	-3.97	-1.11	0.000
Bloomberg–Zacks	90.55	90.58	91.17	91.24	0.37	1.10	0.195
Bloomberg–Capital IQ	88.75	88.59	89.19	89.31	-0.56	0.79	0.291
Zacks–Capital IQ	31.81	32.80	33.07	32.53	1.28	0.64	0.182

Panel C. Provider accuracy shares by GPT-capability regime (percent)

	R0 Pre-ChatGPT	R1 Text-only	R2 Browsing	R3 Native search
I/B/E/S	16.9	18.4	17.6	19.7
FactSet	20.9	19.8	22.4	21.7
Bloomberg	17.2	14.5	14.4	13.6
Zacks	29.5	30.9	29.1	28.6
Capital IQ	16.1	16.9	17.0	16.8
Firm-quarters	4,167	3,287	5,077	4,631

Joint test, all providers: distribution equal across the post-ChatGPT regimes, $\chi^2(8) = 10.8$, $p = 0.214$.

Notes. Panel A reports, for each pair of forecast data providers, the percentage of the 23,833 sample firm-quarters in which the two providers publish different street actuals for the same firm-quarter, where "different" means the two providers' reported actuals are not identical. All five actuals are non-missing for every sample firm-quarter. Panel B reports the same percentage for each pair by GPT-capability regime (R0 to R3 of Appendix A). Its *t*-statistics test the within-firm differences between adjacent regimes in a regression of the pair's disagreement indicator on regime indicators with firm fixed effects, and Joint *p* is the *p*-value of the Wald test that the three regime coefficients are zero, with standard errors clustered by firm. Panel C reports the share of the firm-quarters with complete trailing-error windows for all five providers in which each provider's consensus is the *ex ante* most accurate (lowest trailing four-quarter $MAFE^g$); a firm-quarter with tied lowest $MAFE^g$ is credited to each tied provider, so a column can sum to slightly above one hundred percent. The joint Wald test stacks the five provider-share equations, with standard errors clustered by firm.